

Leveraging Generative AI for Faster, Smarter Design

Kansas City Developer Conference 2025



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Leveraging AI

Goal

To help developers, designers, and PMs overcome their skepticism about AI tools and embrace a fundamentally better way of prototyping that puts human creativity first while automating the grunt work.



Leveraging AI

Prototyping

Framework

1. Capture
2. Research
3. Build
4. Evaluate

Create working prototypes in less time.



Leveraging AI

Benefits

Immediate

Speed, Quality, Collaboration, Creativity

Long-term

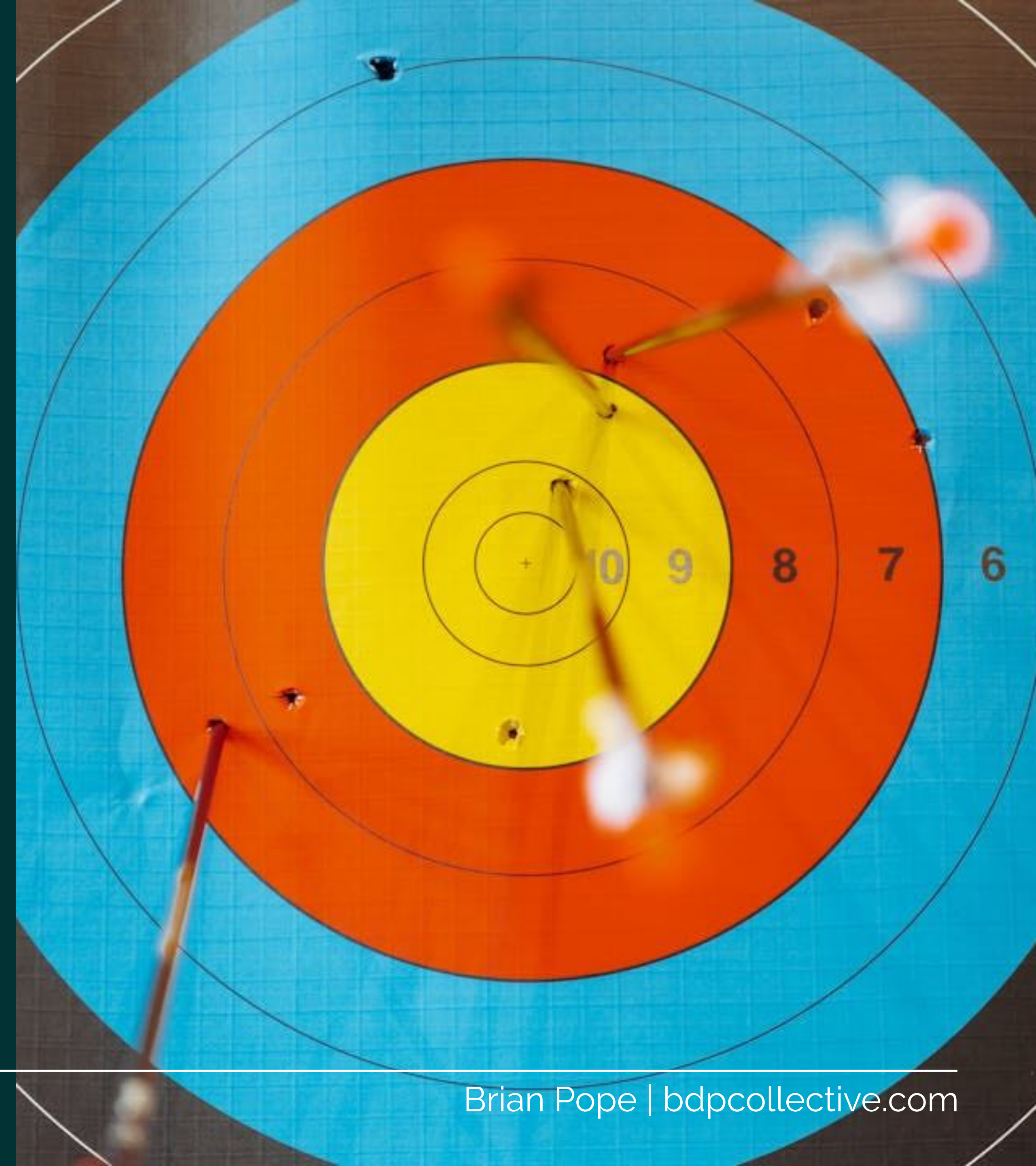
Career Growth, Team Efficiency, Client Relationships

Personal

Less frustration, Creativity, Learning

Business

Faster time to market, Cost savings, Client Satisfaction



Who

Brian Pope

Title:

Principal UX Design Consultant

Company:

DevObsessed

Location:

Omaha, Nebraska



The Project

Quick Deadline

					Independence Day	
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
	Timesheet App					
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
Timesheet App						
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
Timesheet App						
27	28	29	30	31	Aug 1	2
Timesheet App						

The Stakes

Build a Working Timesheet Application Prototype

- Not wireframes
- Not mockups
- Something clients can test



Old vs. New

Software Design Process

Traditional

1. Discovery
2. Workflows
3. Information architecture
4. Wireframes
5. High-Fidelity
6. Iterations

New (Work in progress)

1. Capture
2. Research
3. Build
4. Evaluate

How good could it be?

The Skeptic's Journey

I was a skeptic

“AI is a fad. We’ve seen this before, right?”

~Me 3 months ago

Traditional Prototyping

- Designer is a sprint ahead
- Developer gives input on mocks
- Product manager mediates client needs between designer and dev
- Designer updates mocks
- Rinse and repeat



The Real Cost

Time, energy & Money

- Multiple revisions
- Time spent debating details that may or may not matter
- Teams spending extra time reviewing and critiquing



My “Aha” moment

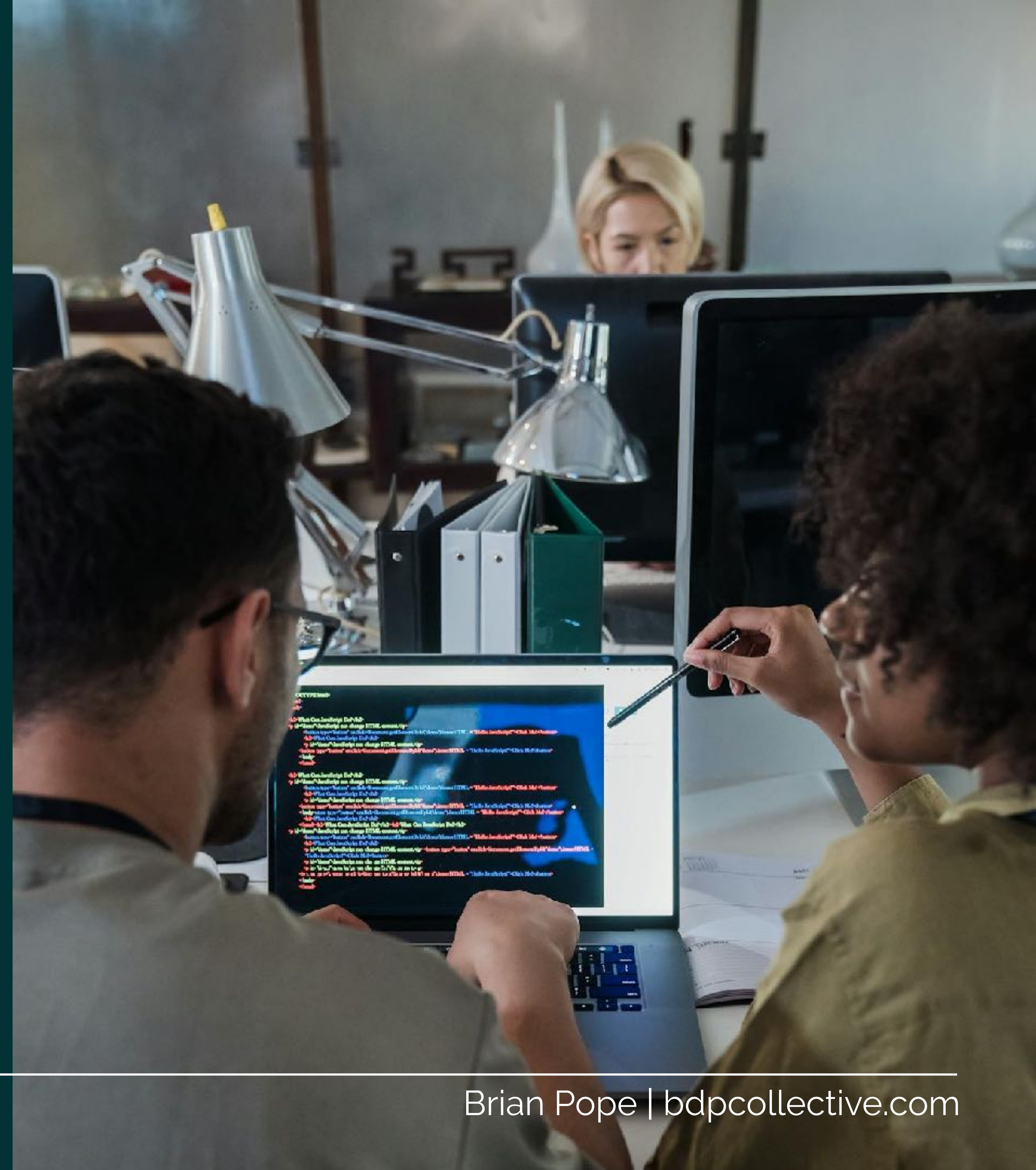
“Traditional prototyping wasn’t just slow. . . its fundamentally broken.”



2. The Breakthrough

AI Prototyping

- Recording and collecting all conversations
- Team makes decisions based on knowledge and project context
- We give AI context and use our expertise, build a prototype
- Refine prototype with team and test with users



The Catalyst

Context is everything

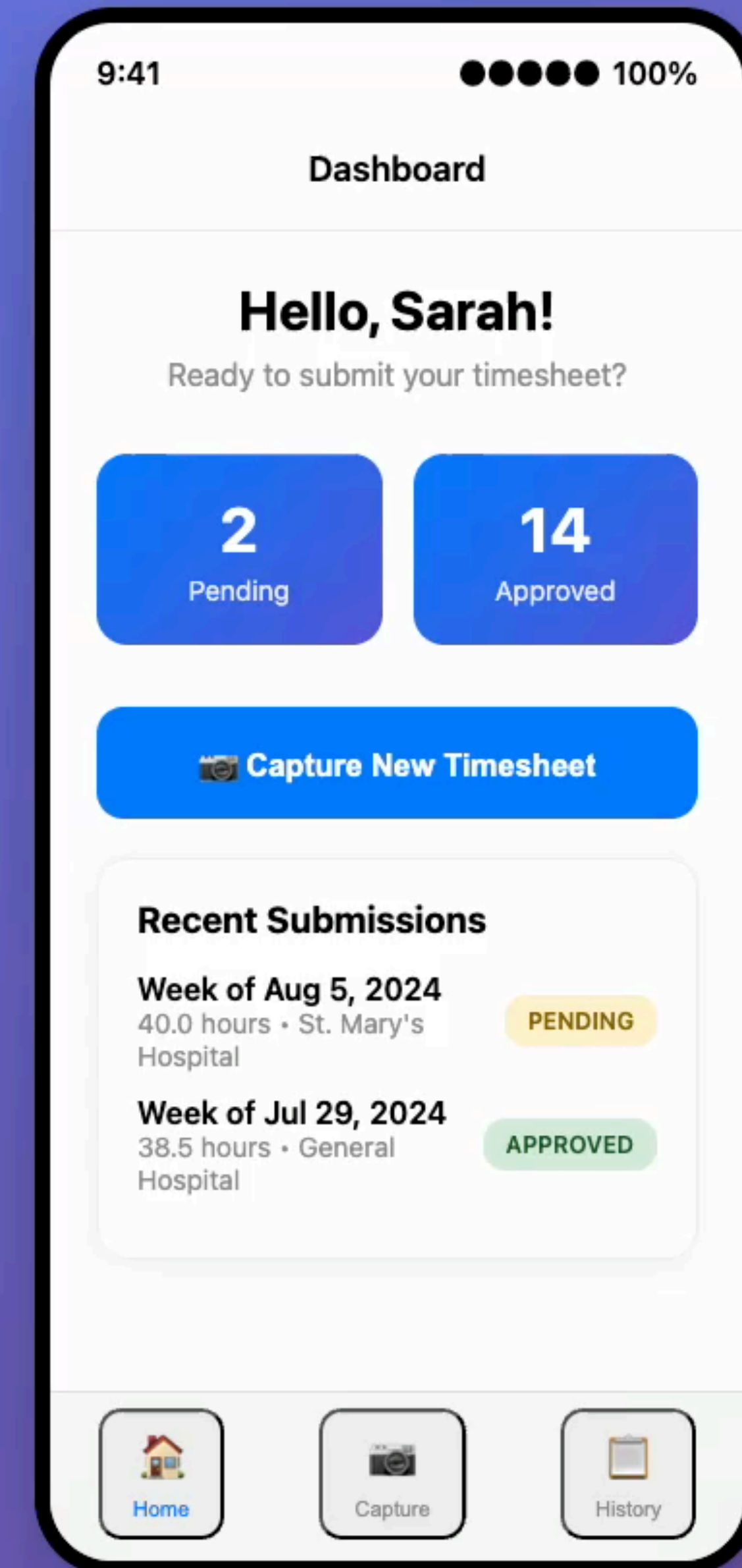
- Before/ After Comparison
 - One-shot “Help me build a timesheet app”
 - “Here is the users background, applications they are used to using, type of computer user they are, etc.”
- Key Insight: Context changes everything- **Your AI needs good context to make design decisions**



The Timesheet Surprise

AI created an initial prototype that was different than anything I would have come up with.

Key realization : **AI was solving and design problems, not just regurgitating**



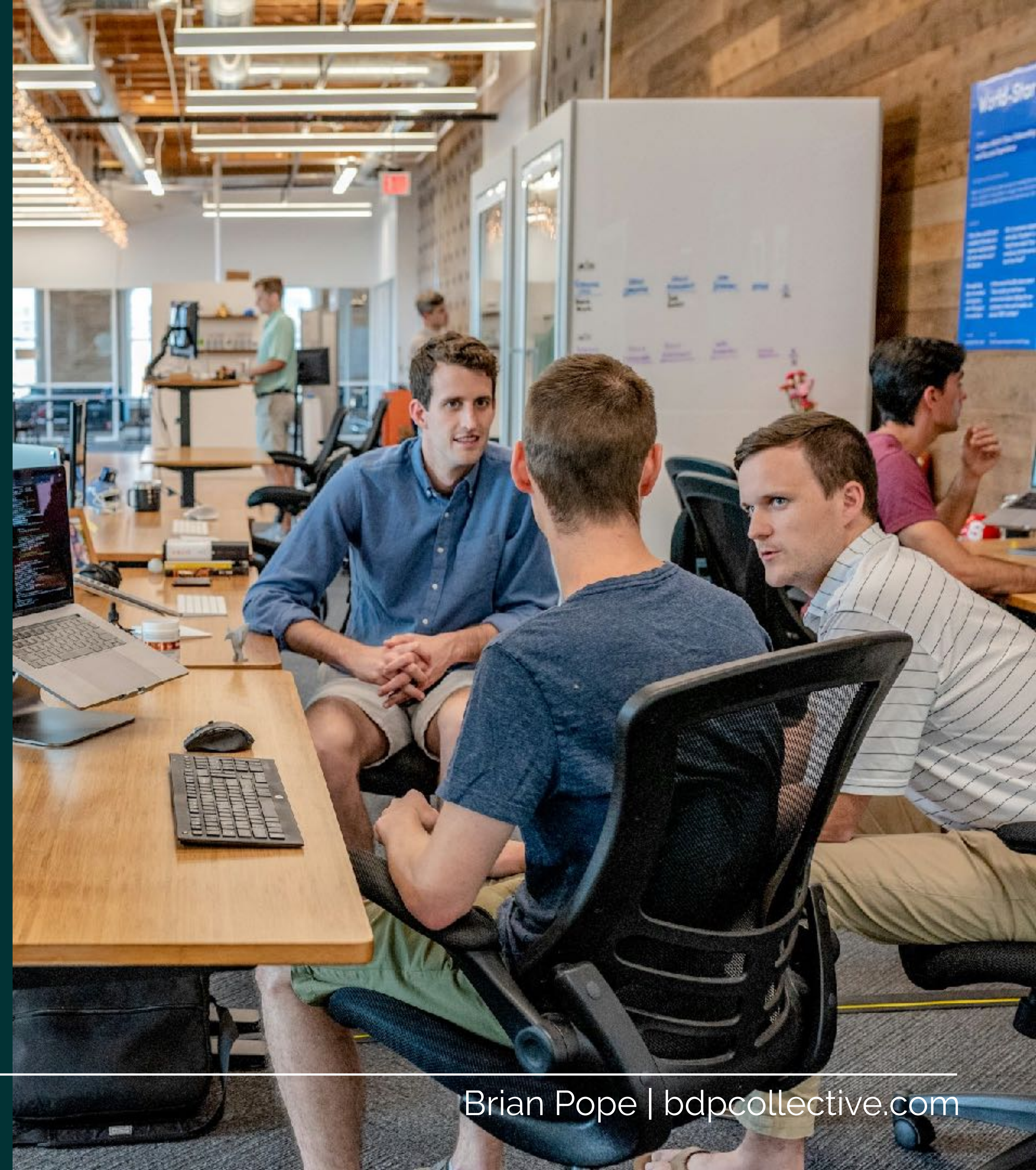
New Paradigm

Client Context + AI =

Solutions that encapsulate in more detail

Meeting transcripts + App Workflows +
Timesheets + Styles =

Tailored prototypes



Real Time Collaboration

“We come to a consensus faster. Building prototypes, live, in meetings, with everyone's expertise applied immediately leads to better ideas overall.”

3. The New Process

Framework

From paper timesheets to digital workflow in 6 weeks.



Capture

Gather information,
data, and insights.
Understand Roadmap

Framework

From paper timesheets to digital workflow in 6 weeks.



Capture

Gather information,
data, and insights.
Understand Roadmap



Clarification Loop

Analyze and
extract
key elements.
Add to .md file

Framework

From paper timesheets to digital workflow in 6 weeks.



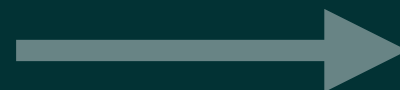
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Understand Roadmap



Research

Understand
Competitors, Users
similar patterns



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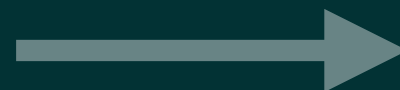
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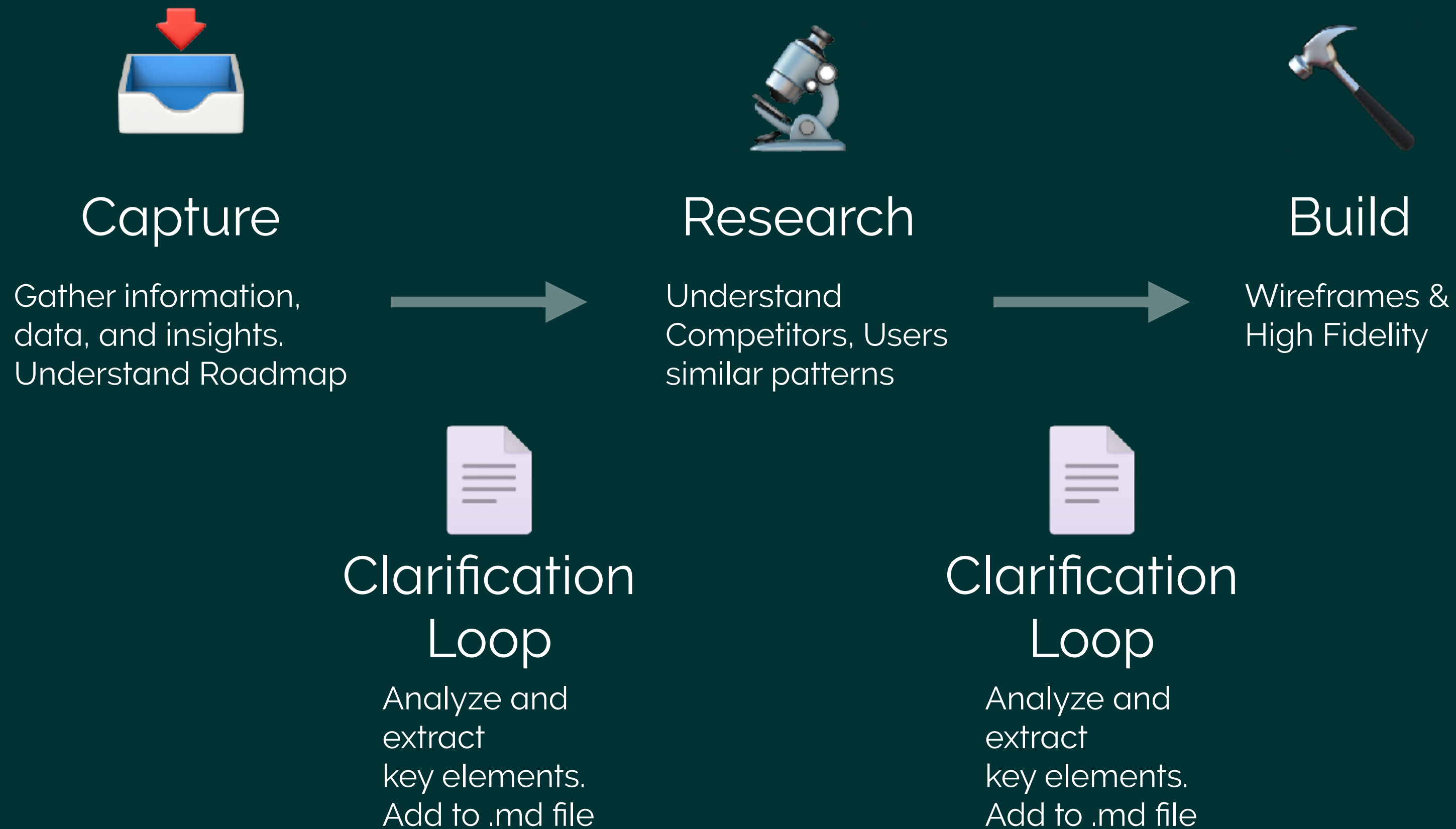


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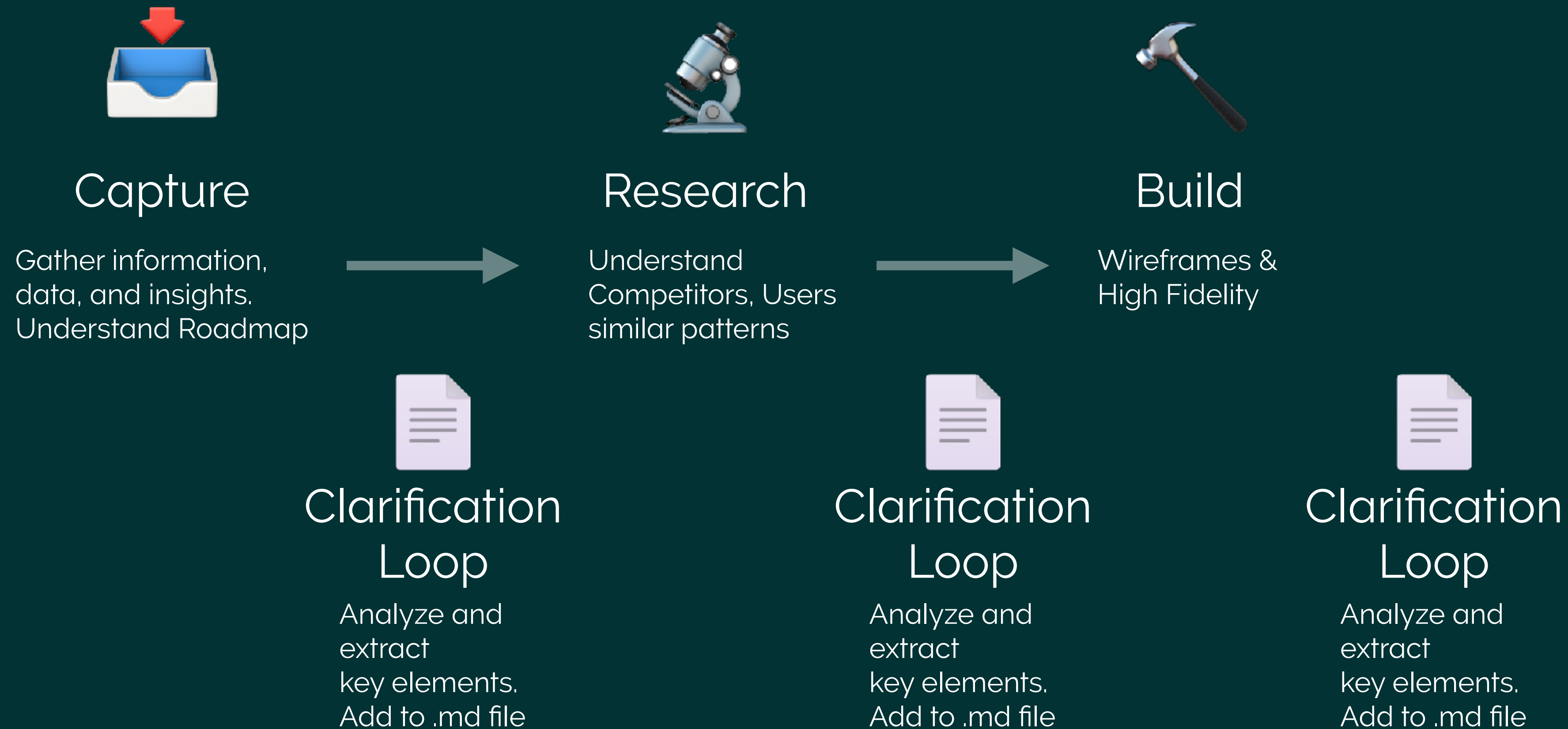
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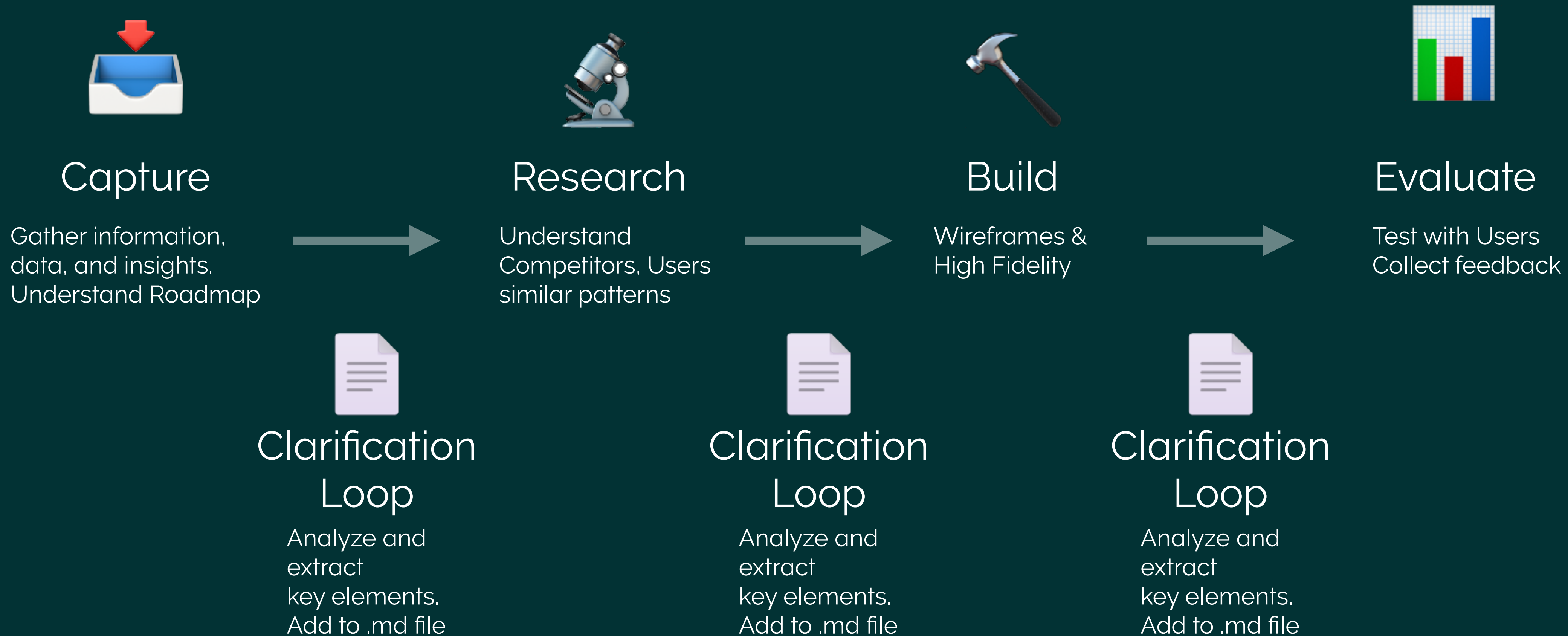
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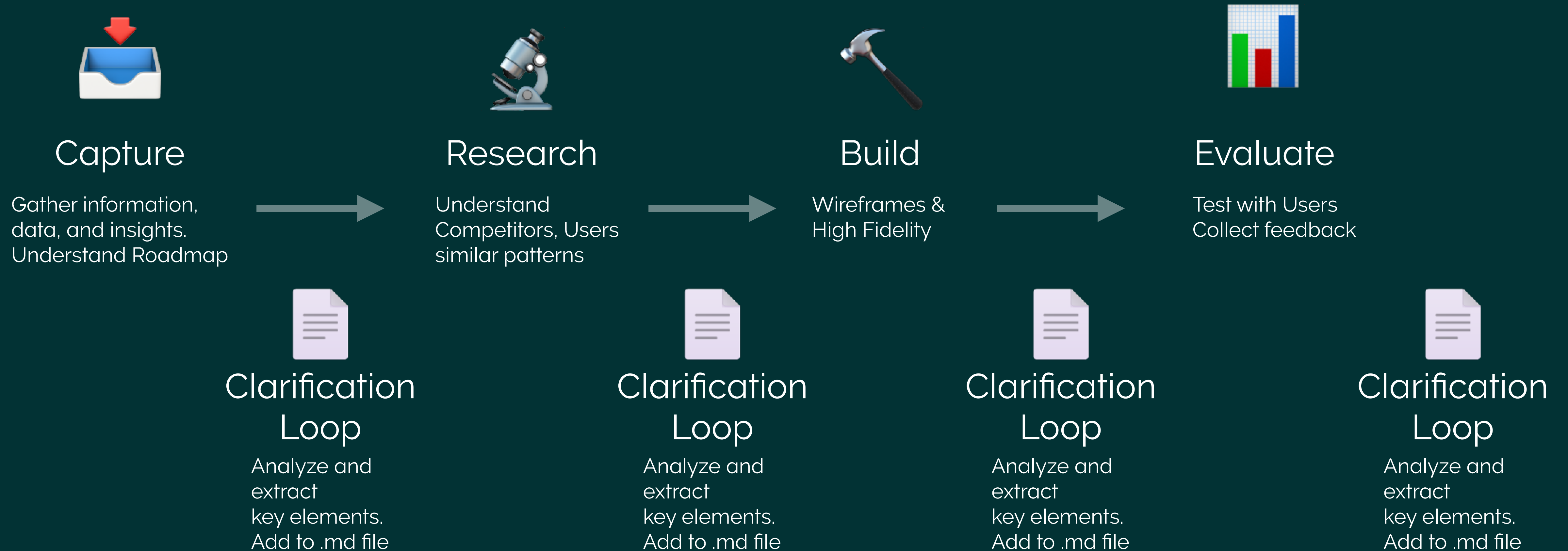
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Framework

From paper timesheets to digital workflow in 6 weeks.



Capture

Context is King

- Record client discussions and team meetings



Capture

Context is King

- Record client discussions and team meetings
- Save in project folder



Capture

Context is King

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- Save in project folder
- Kick-off meeting with client for alignment



Capture

Context is King

- Record client discussions and team meetings
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- Add any correlated documents that we think might help (Statement of Work)



Capture

Context is King

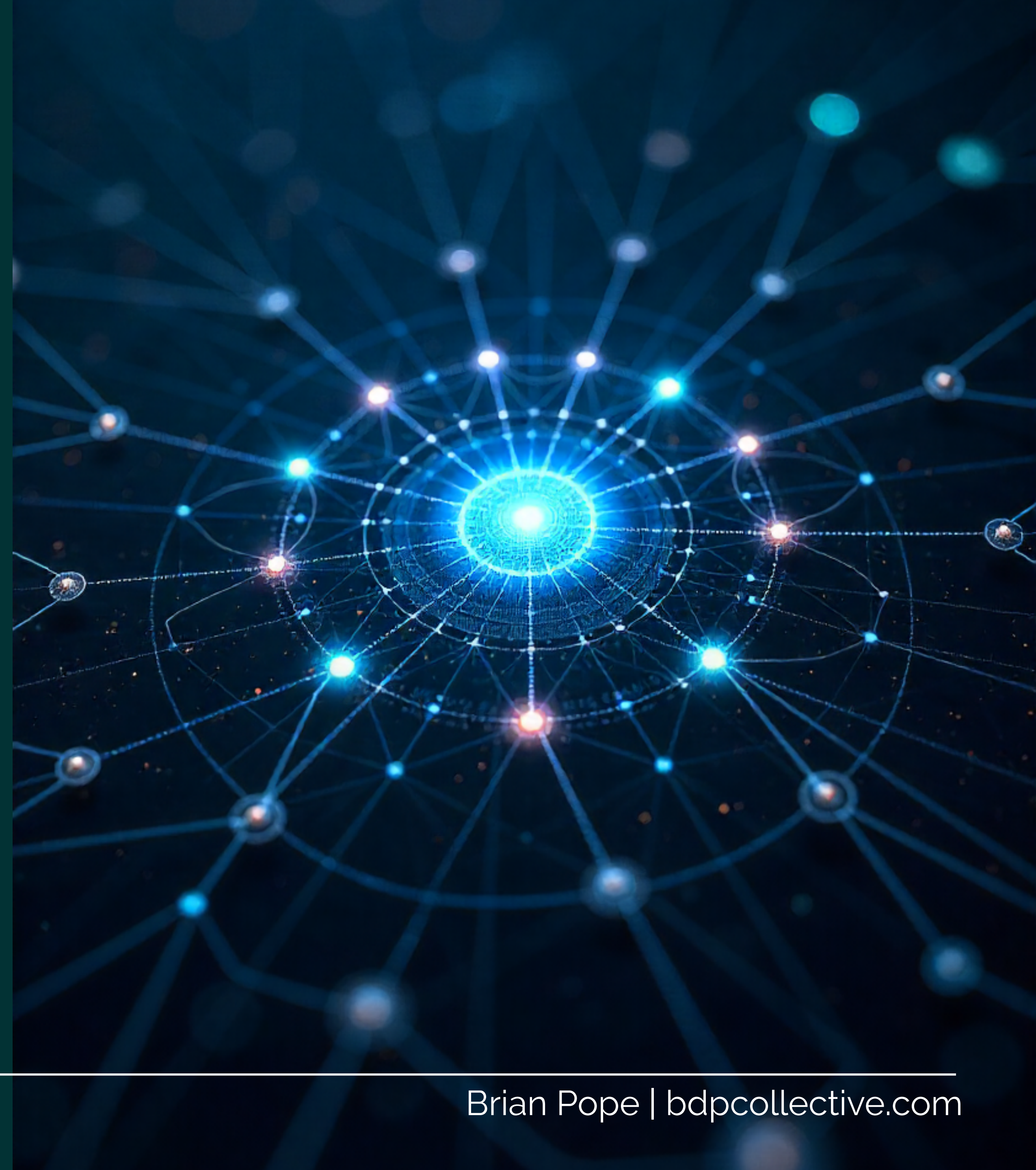
- Record client discussions and team meetings
- Save in project folder
- Kick-off meeting with client for alignment
- Add any correlated documents that we think might help (Statement of Work)
- Align on goals and scope



Research

Collect Information

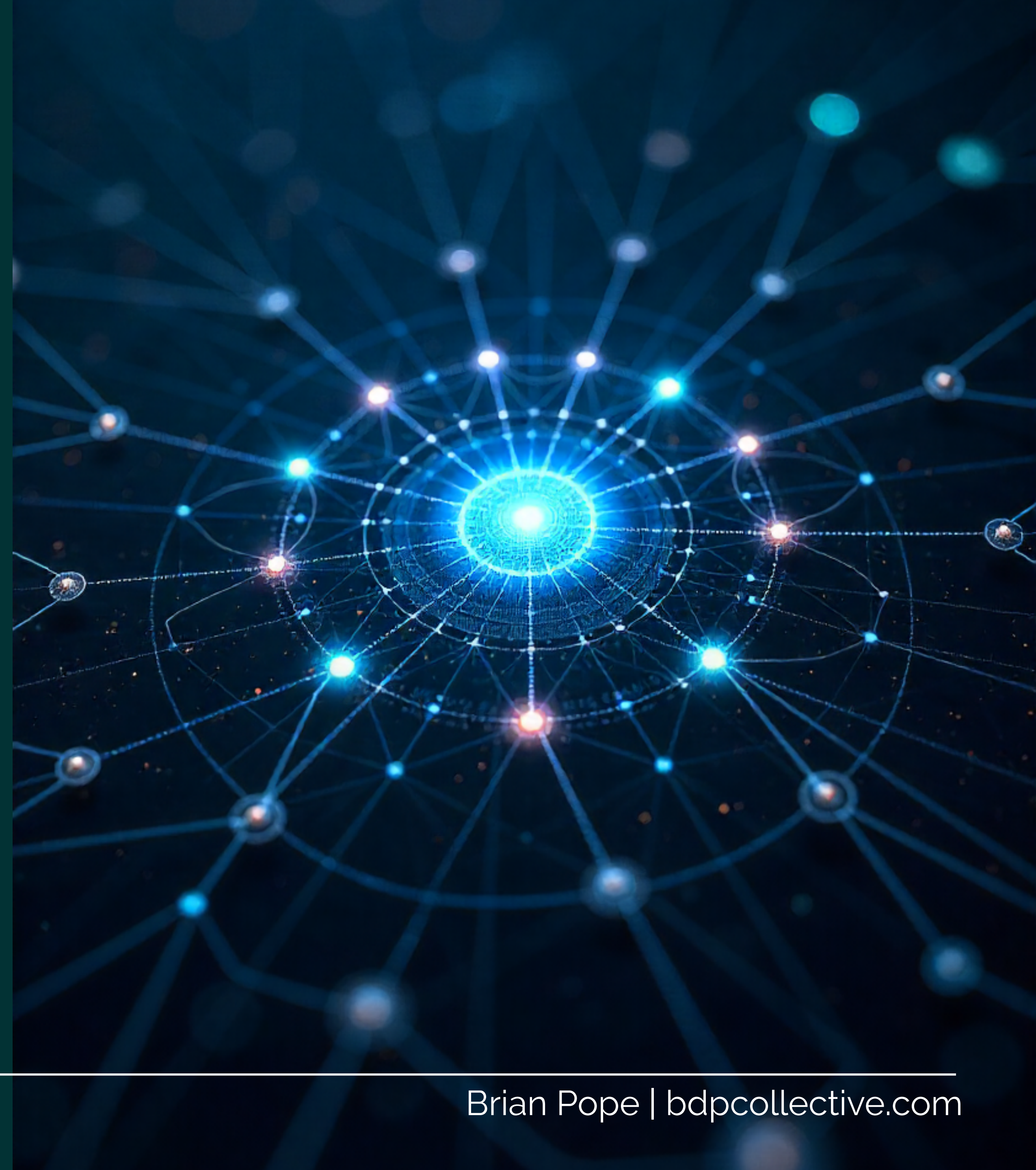
- Document User Information



Research

Collect Information

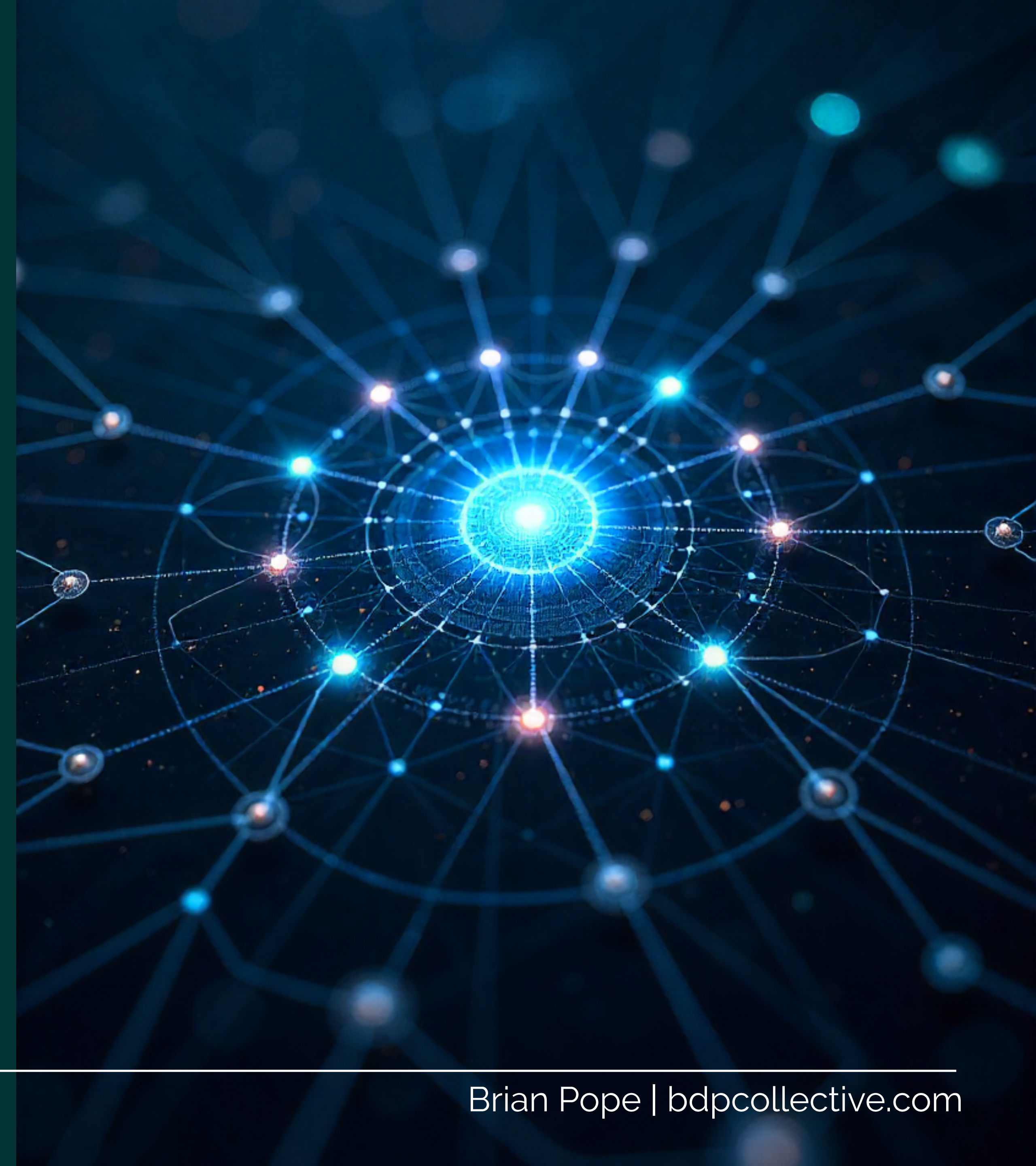
- Document User Information
- Research Competitors



Research

Collect Information

- Document User Information
- Research Competitors
- Research design patterns for functionality



Build

Generating PRD

- PRD (Product Requirements Document)

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Akutime - AI-Powered Nurse Timesheet Management App

1. Executive Summary

Product Name: Akutime

Version: 1.0

Date: August 2025

Team: Healthcare Technology Division

Akutime is a mobile-first timesheet management application designed specifically for healthcare workers, with initial focus on nursing staff. The app leverages AI-powered photo capture technology to digitize paper timesheets and streamlines the approval workflow between nurses and their supervisors.

Key Value Proposition: Transform tedious manual timesheet entry into a seamless, AI-assisted mobile experience that reduces administrative burden while maintaining compliance and accuracy.

2. Product Overview

2.1 Problem Statement

Healthcare workers, particularly nurses, face significant administrative overhead managing paper-based timesheets. Current pain points include:

- Time-consuming manual data entry from paper forms
- Risk of transcription errors
- Delayed approval workflows
- Poor visibility into timesheet status
- Difficulty tracking historical records
- Manual signature collection processes

2.2 Solution

Created by You  Private

How can I help you today?

+

 Research

Claude Sonnet 4

⌵

↑

Your chats

Activity

 Your chats are private until shared

Start a chat to keep conversations organized and re-use project knowledge.

Project knowledge



Set project instructions

Optional



No knowledge added yet. Add PDFs, documents, or other text to the project knowledge base that Claude will reference in every project conversation.



Created by You Private

I would like to build wireframes for a mobile app using the akutime_prd.md

Design should look like gray border wireframe boxes to show functionality without any style

I will only need this in HTML and CSS

Ask me any questions that would help make clarify any unknowns.



Research

Claude Sonnet 4



Your chats

Activity



Your chats are private until shared

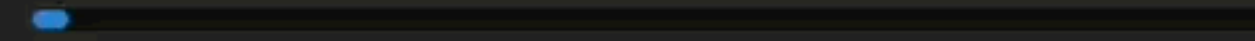
Start a chat to keep conversations organized and re-use project knowledge.

Project knowledge



Set project instructions

Optional



Supervised
Slingshot -
2025_07_23...

621 lines

MD

Meeting started
2025_07_23 13_30
CDT - Notes by...

1,926 lines

MD

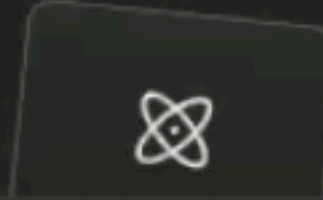
akutime_prd.md

387 lines

MD

AG The bottom menu is getting cut off at the bottom. Can you fix the menu to fit with this size of screen?

Akutime Mobile App Wireframes
Interactive artifact · Version 3



Perfect! I've fixed the bottom navigation menu by:

1. **Adding flexbox layout** to the phone frame (`display: flex; flex-direction: column`)
2. **Making the content area flexible** (`flex: 1`) so it takes up available space
3. **Removing the fixed height** from the content area

Now the bottom navigation menu will always be visible at the bottom of each screen, and the content area will automatically adjust to fit the remaining space. The menu should no longer be cut off regardless of the content length.

I would like to build a High-Fidelity Prototype for a mobile app using the akutime_prd.md and the wireframes in the arifact above. Please make this into a clickable prototype without a login

Please make this WCAG Compliant

Design should look like iOS 18 to show interaction and styling.

AG

Make this as easy as possible for users by using Nielsen Normans 10 Usability Heuristics <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/>

I will only need this in HTML and CSS

Ask me any questions that would help make clarify any unknowns.

Editing this message will create a new conversation branch. You can switch between branches using the arrow navigation buttons.

Cancel

Save

Can we change this into a clickable prototype

Claude Sonnet 4

Smart, efficient model for everyday use [Learn more](#)

Artifacts



Akutime Mobile App Wireframes

Click to open website • 3 versions



Akutime High-Fidelity iOS 18 Prototype

Click to open website • 3 versions

Project content

KCDC

Created by You

Supervised
Slingshot -
2025_07_23...

621 lines

MD

Meeting started
2025_07_23
13_30 CDT -...

1,926 lines

MD

akutime_prd.md
387 lines

MD

Content

No content added yet

Add images, PDFs, docs, spreadsheets, and more to summarize, analyze, and query content with Claude.

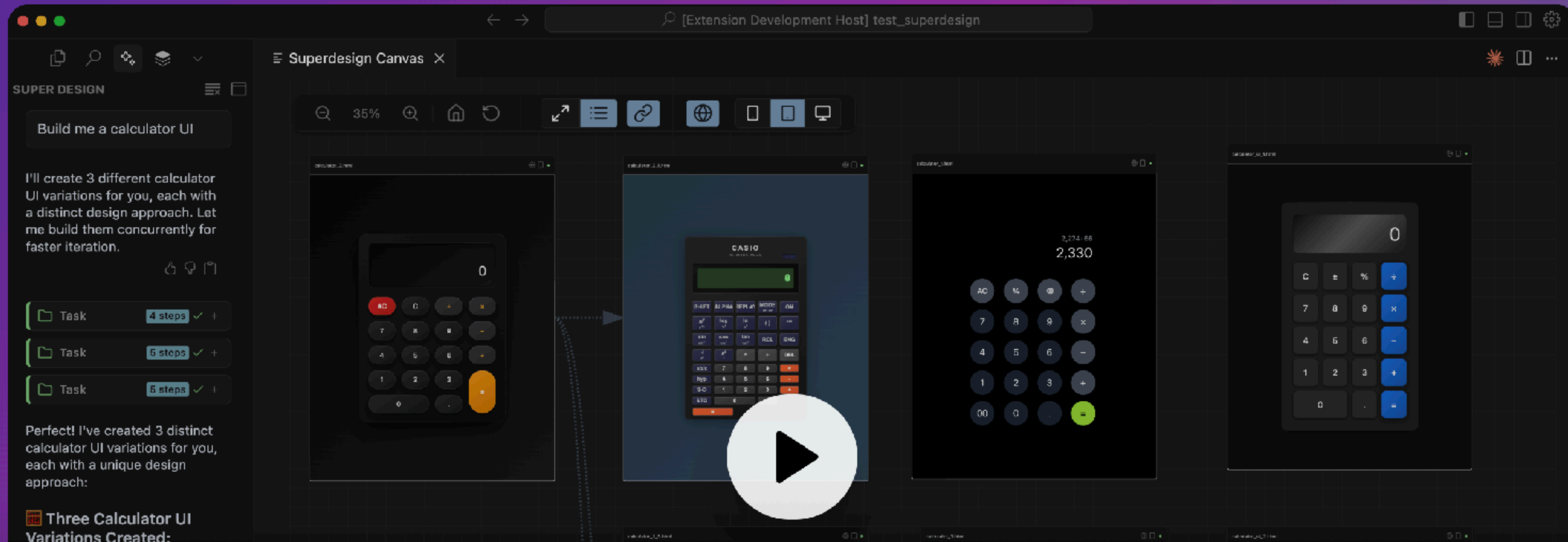
The Cursor for Design

The 1st Design Agent lives inside your IDE

INSTALL FOR FREE

GITHUB

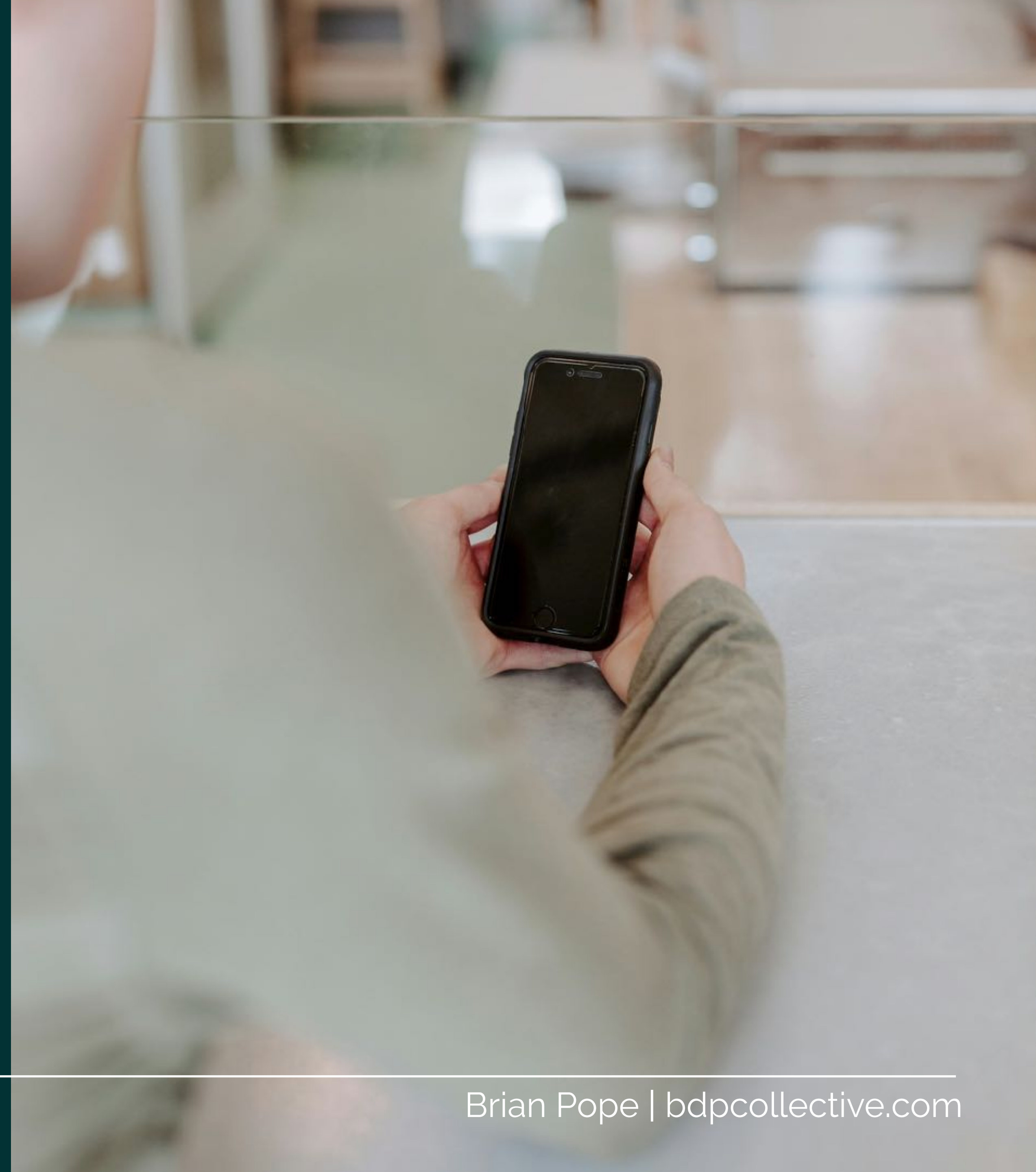
DISCORD



Evaluate

Test with stakeholders and users

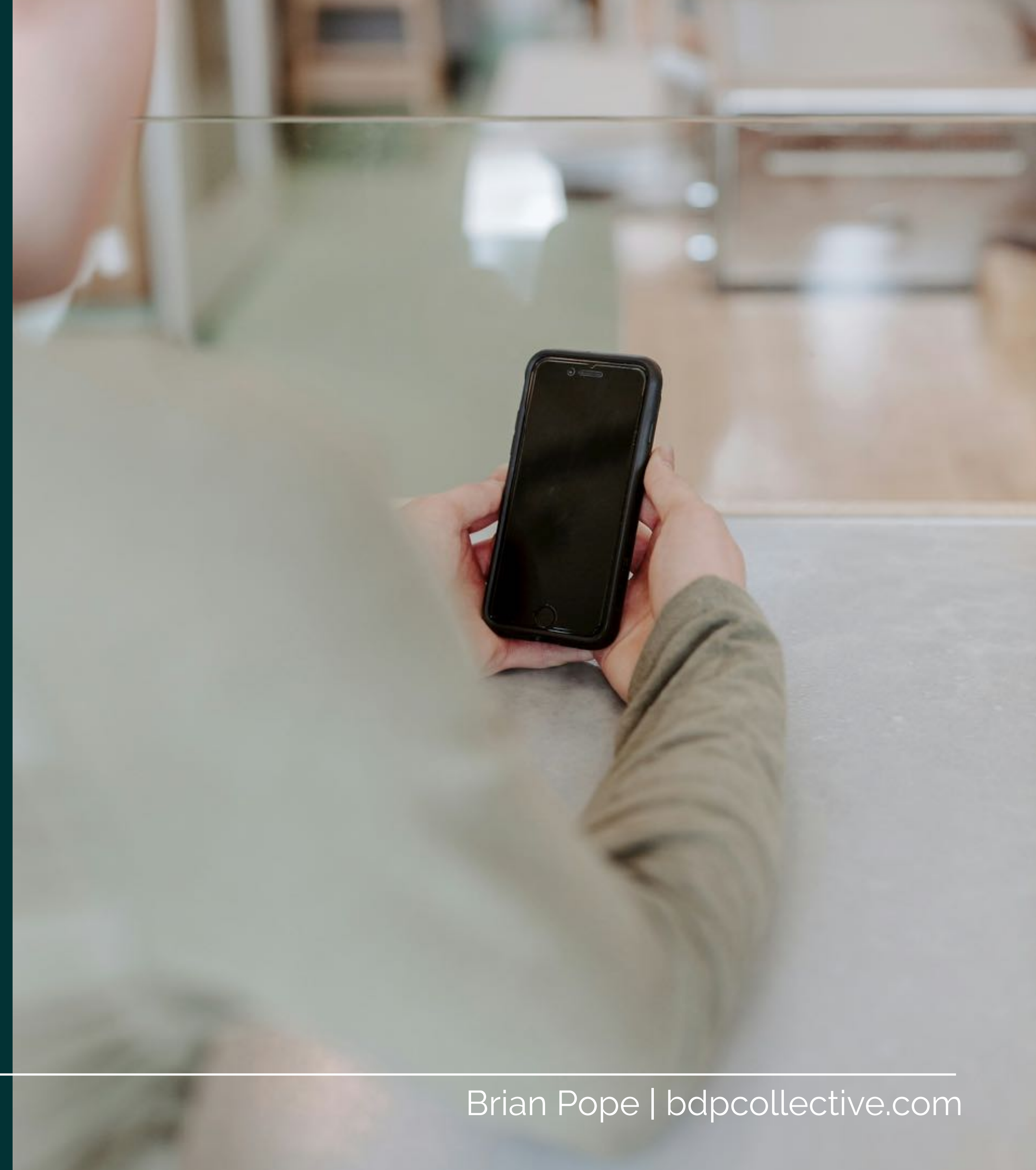
- Internal team demo to align and fine tune (Can update live)



Evaluate

Test with stakeholders and users

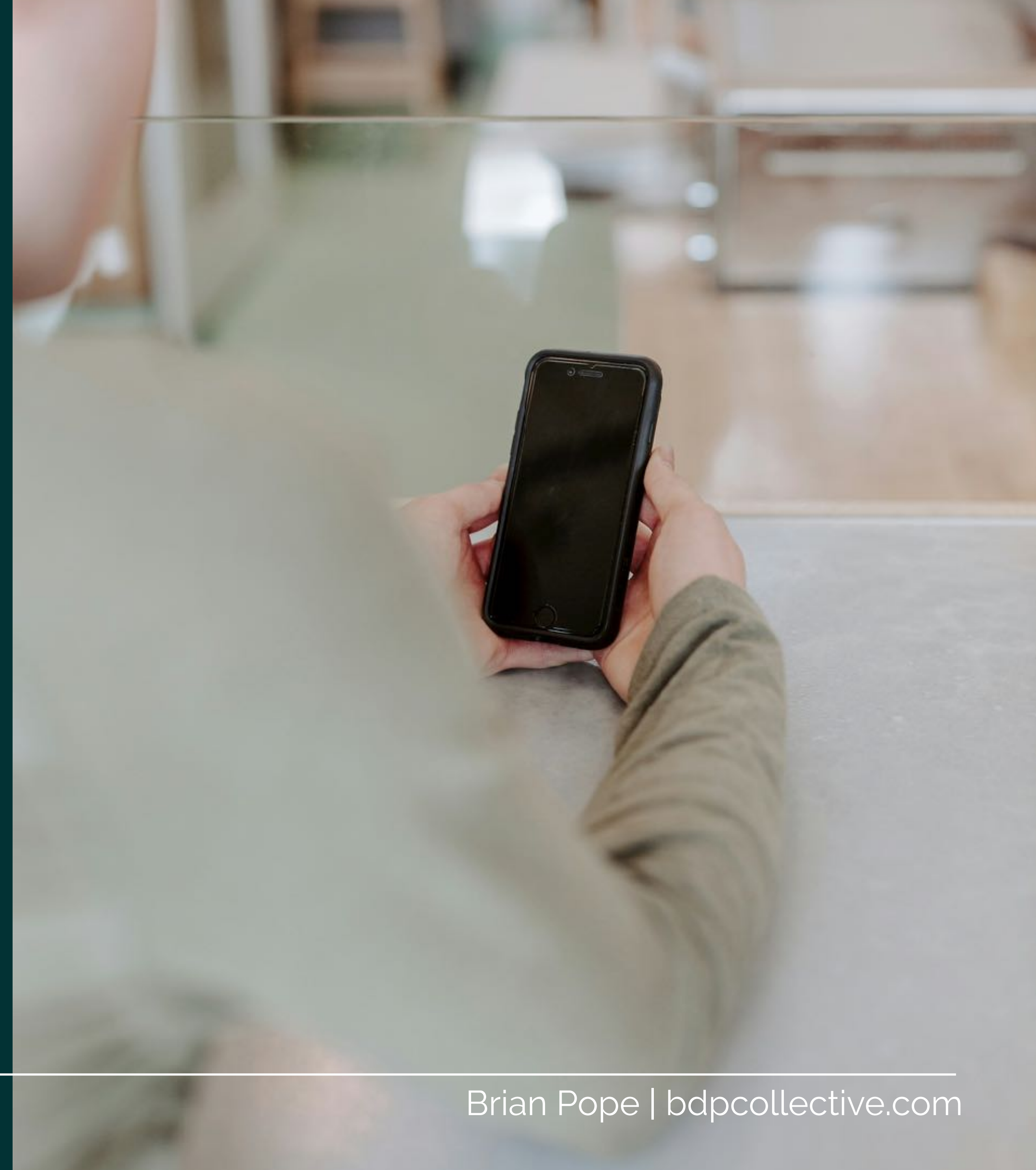
- Internal team demo to align and fine tune (Can update live)
- Client review



Evaluate

Test with stakeholders and users

- Internal team demo to align and fine tune (Can update live)
- Client review
- User Testing with real users

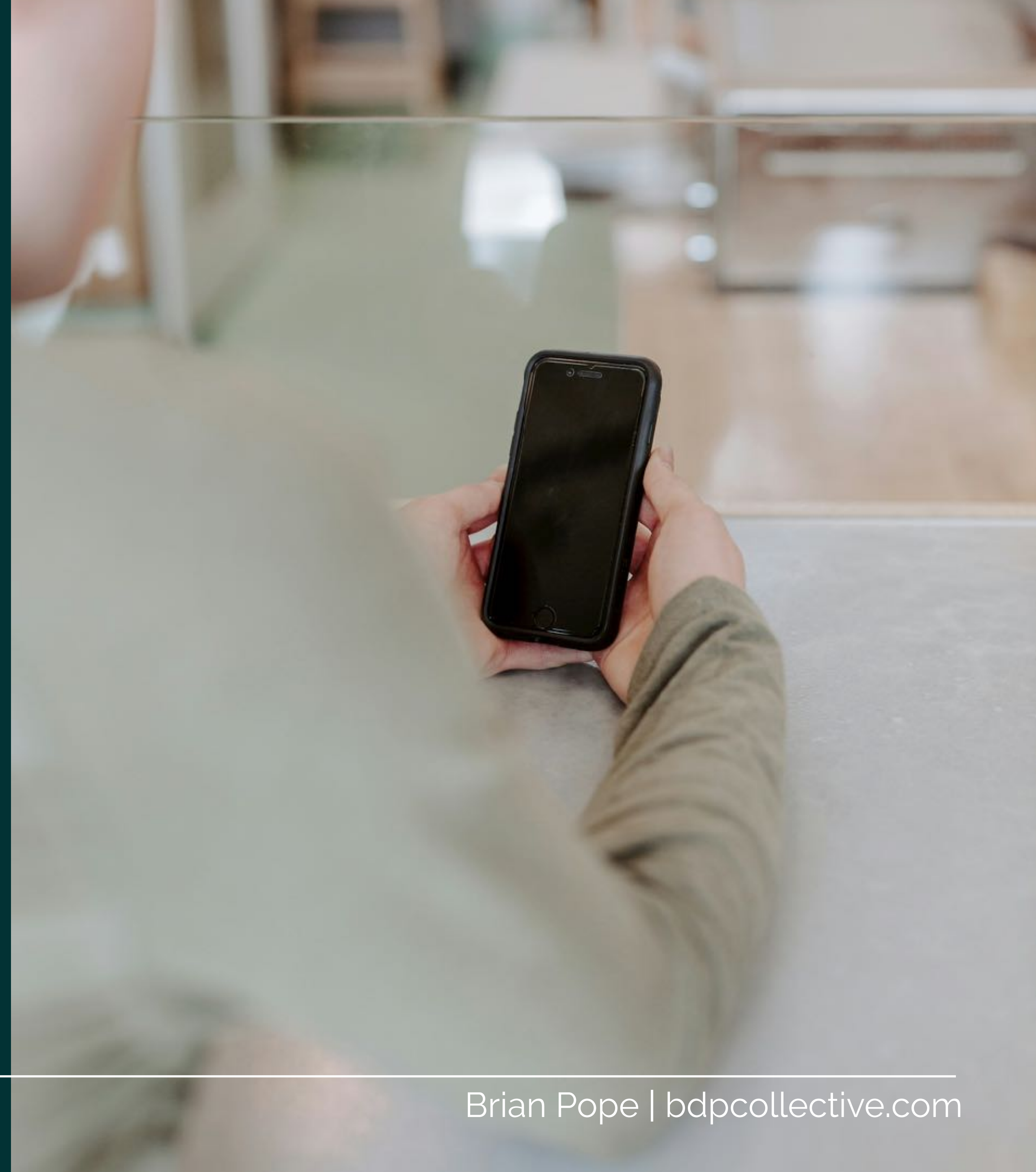


Evaluate

Test with stakeholders and users

- Internal team demo to align and fine tune (Can update live)
- Client review
- User Testing with real users

Result is a working prototype in a browser and can test with Expo



4. The Wisdom Gained

AI Prototyping

Feed LLM context

- Give the LLM context (User Needs, Business Goals, Technology)

AI Prototyping

Feed LLM context

- Give the LLM context (User Needs, Business Goals, Technology)
- Have a discussion with the LLM

AI Prototyping

Feed LLM context

- Give the LLM context (User Needs, Business Goals, Technology)
- Have a discussion with the LLM
- Save general guidelines in a .md file

AI Prototyping

Feed LLM context

- Give the LLM context (User Needs, Business Goals, Technology)
- Have a discussion with the LLM
- Save general guidelines in a .md file
- Let the LLM build a prototype. I used Claude for the first draft. Cursor for making adjustments.

What we automate

Tasks we don't want to do

- Breaking epics into tasks - Github Project



What we automate

Tasks we don't want to do

- Breaking epics into tasks - Github Project
- Building complex UI components



What we automate

Tasks we don't want to do

- Breaking epics into tasks - Github Project
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- Exploring Visual Styles



What we automate

Tasks we don't want to do

- Breaking epics into tasks - Github Project
- Building complex UI components
- Exploring Visual Styles
- Adding interactivity and sound



What we automate

Tasks we don't want to do

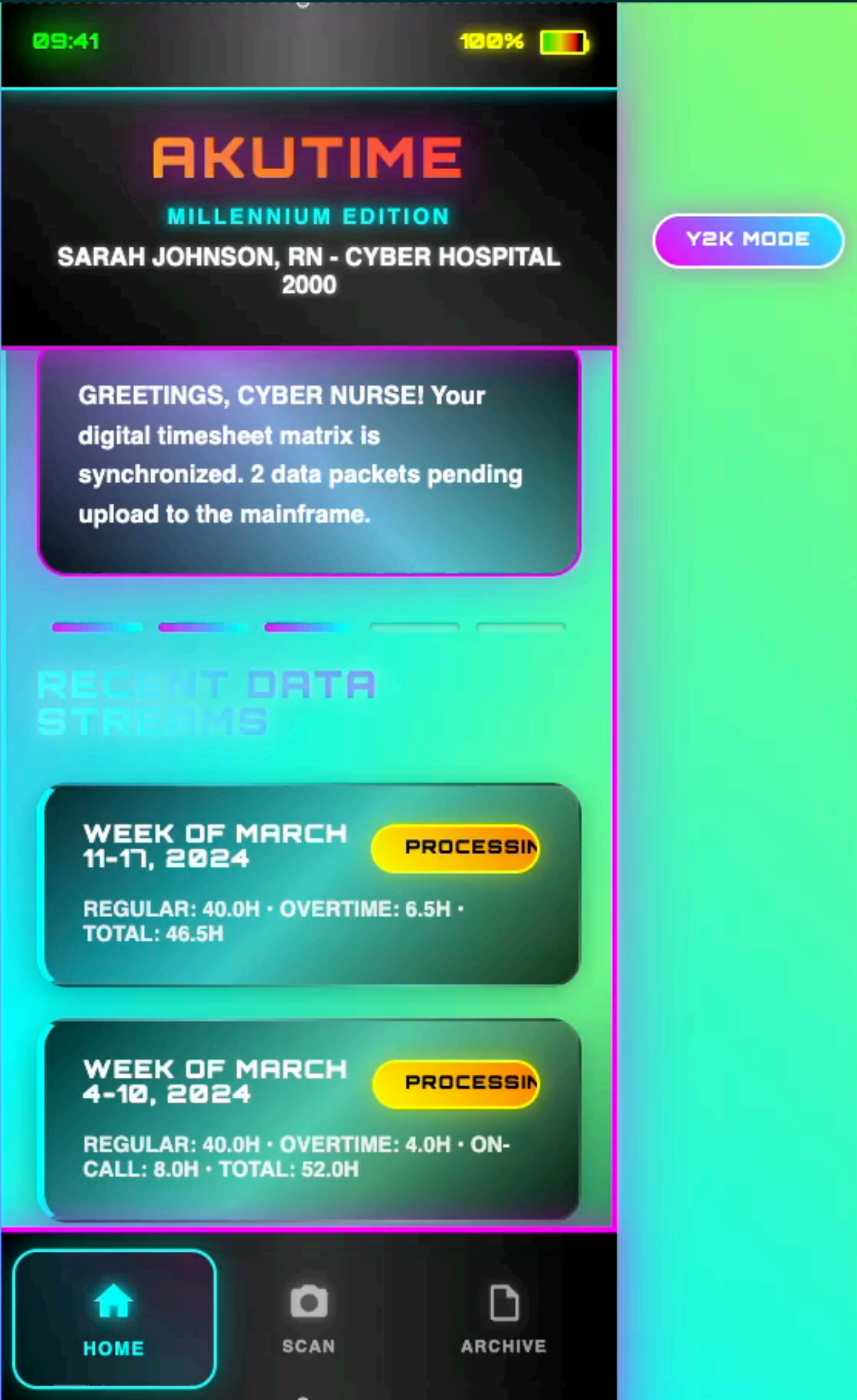
- Breaking epics into tasks - Github Project
- Building complex UI components
- Exploring Visual Styles
- Adding interactivity and sound
- Theme updates and variations



Creative Exploration

Examples of different Visual style with AI

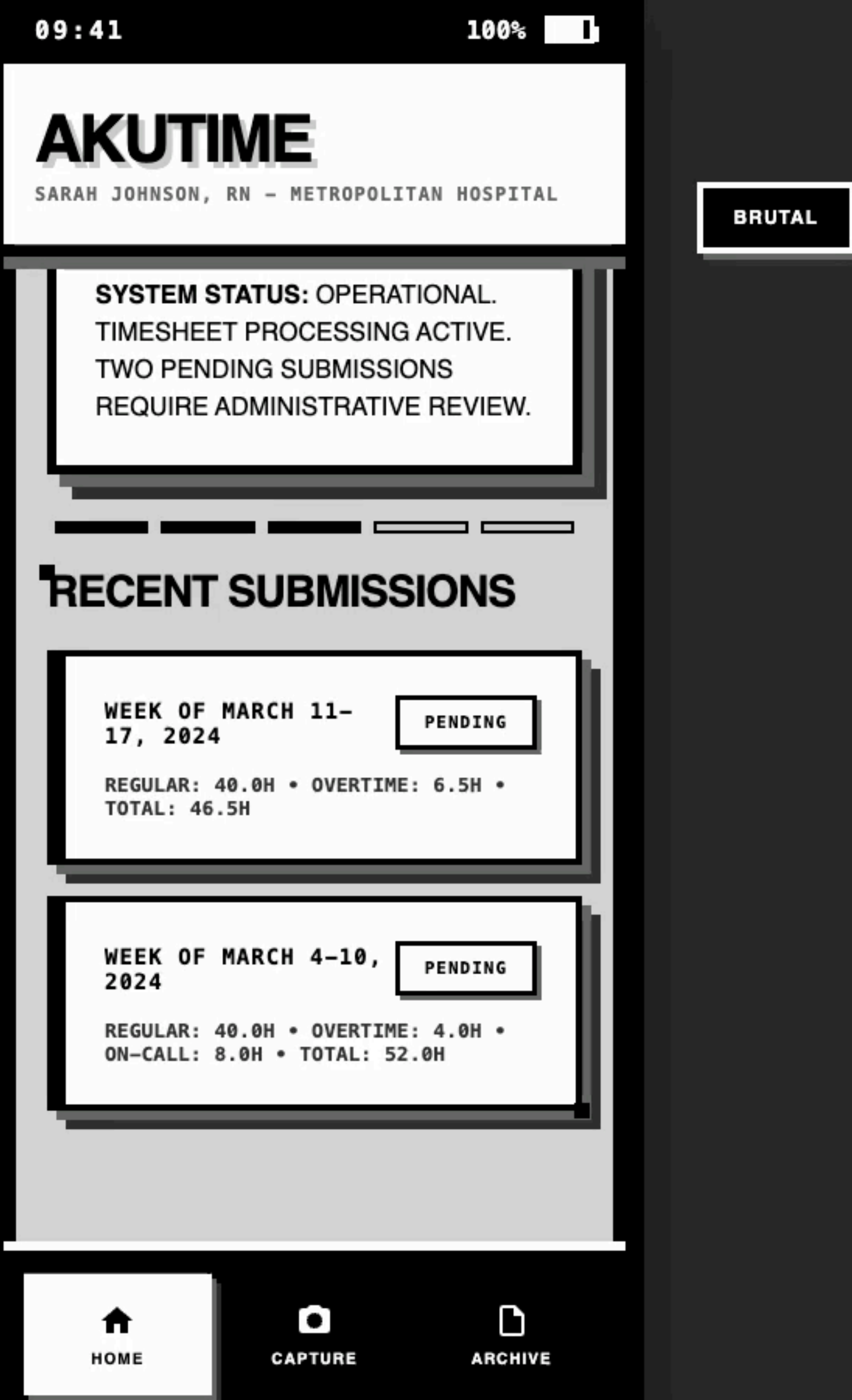
Y2K



Creative Exploration

Examples of different Visual style with AI

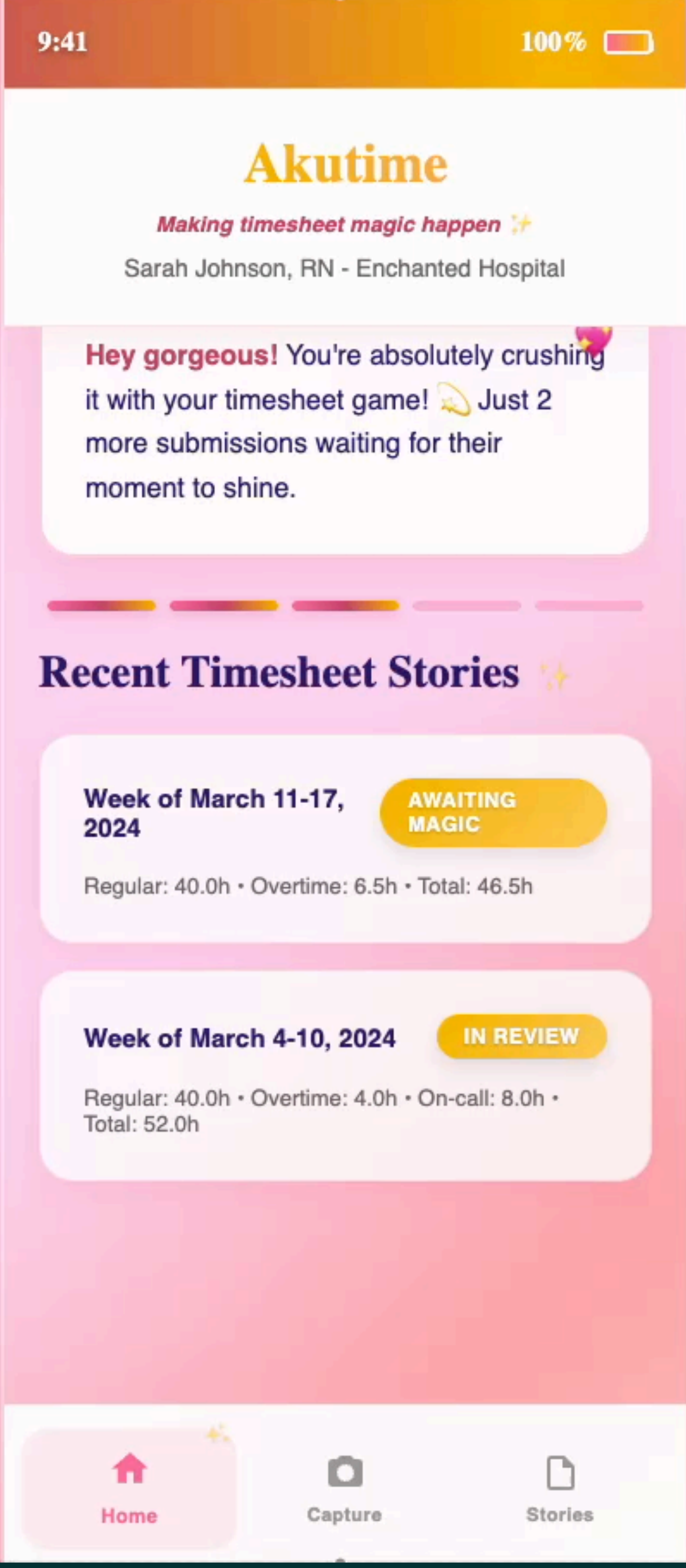
Brutalist



Creative Exploration

Examples of different Visual style with AI

Taylor Swift



AI Doesn't Replace Creativity

Human Roles

- Critical evaluation



AI Doesn't Replace Creativity

Human Roles

- Critical evaluation
- Design Knowledge



AI Doesn't Replace Creativity

Human Roles

- Critical evaluation
- Design Knowledge
- Organizing Context



AI Doesn't Replace Creativity

Human Roles

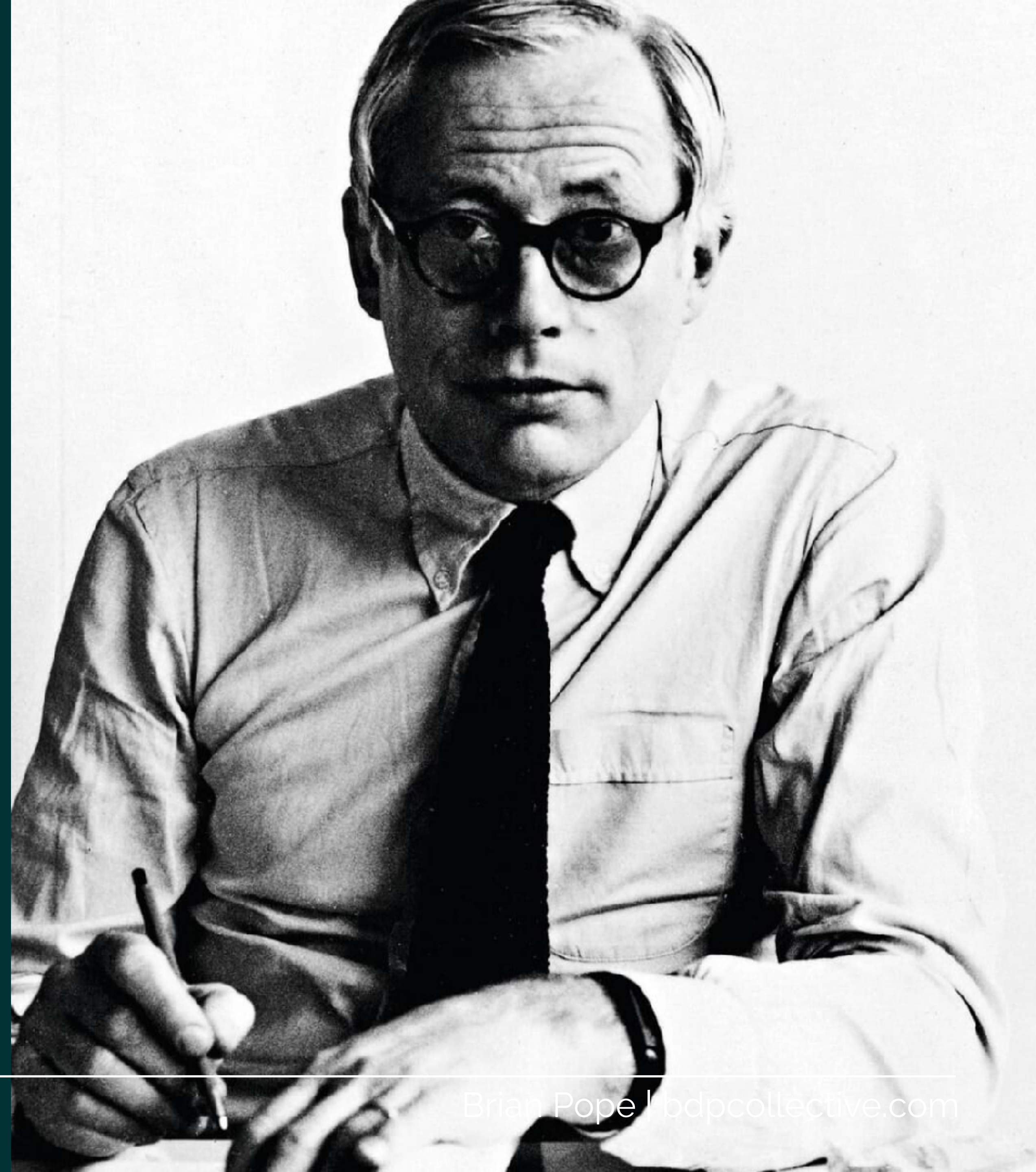
- Critical evaluation
- Design Knowledge
- Organizing Context
- Final Decision Making



Teaching AI Good Taste

Techniques

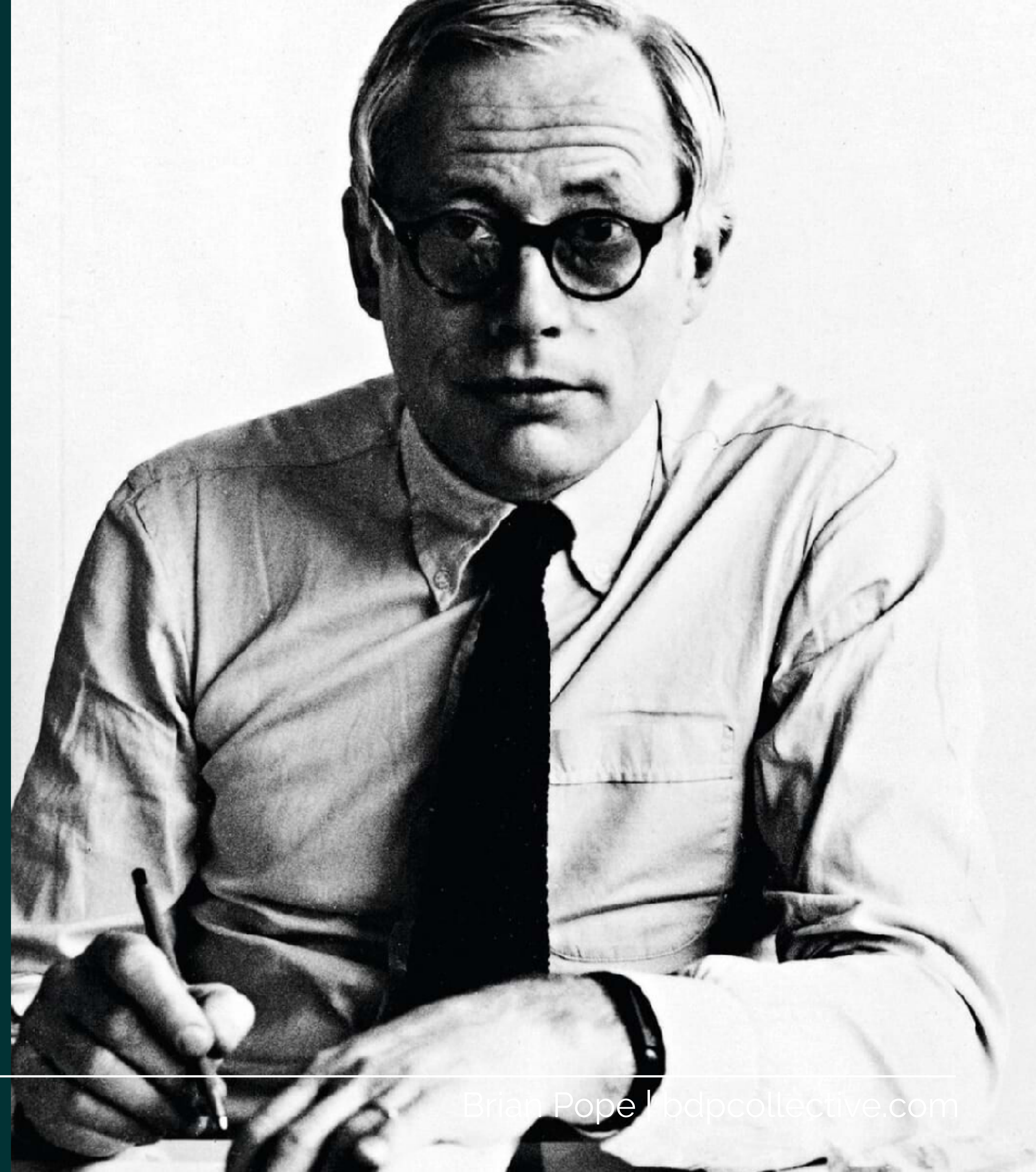
- Use design references (Edward Tufte, Apple, Stripe, Dieter Rams, etc.)



Teaching AI Good Taste

Techniques

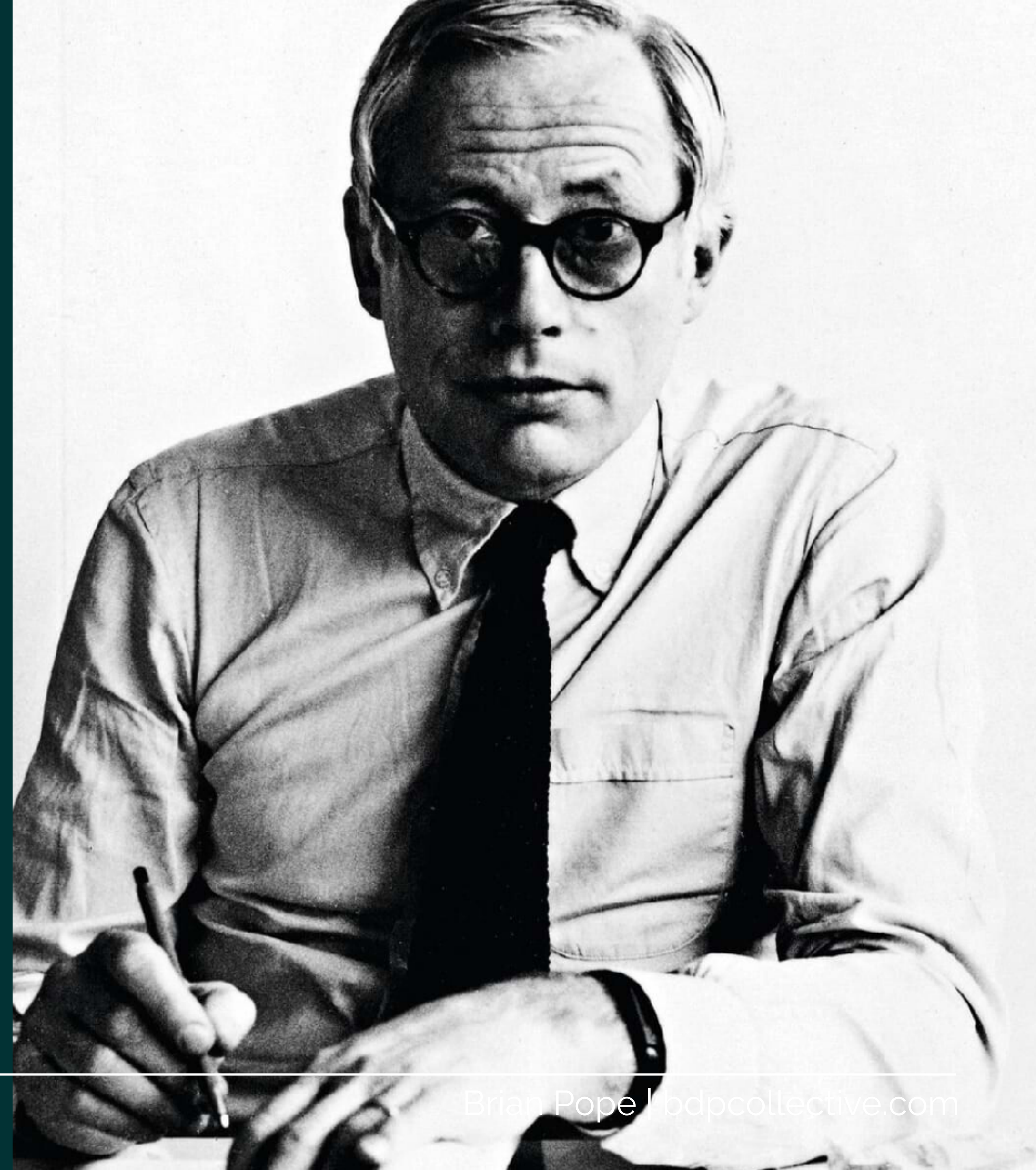
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- Broaden inspiration sources (Music videos, Art, Culture)



Teaching AI Good Taste

Techniques

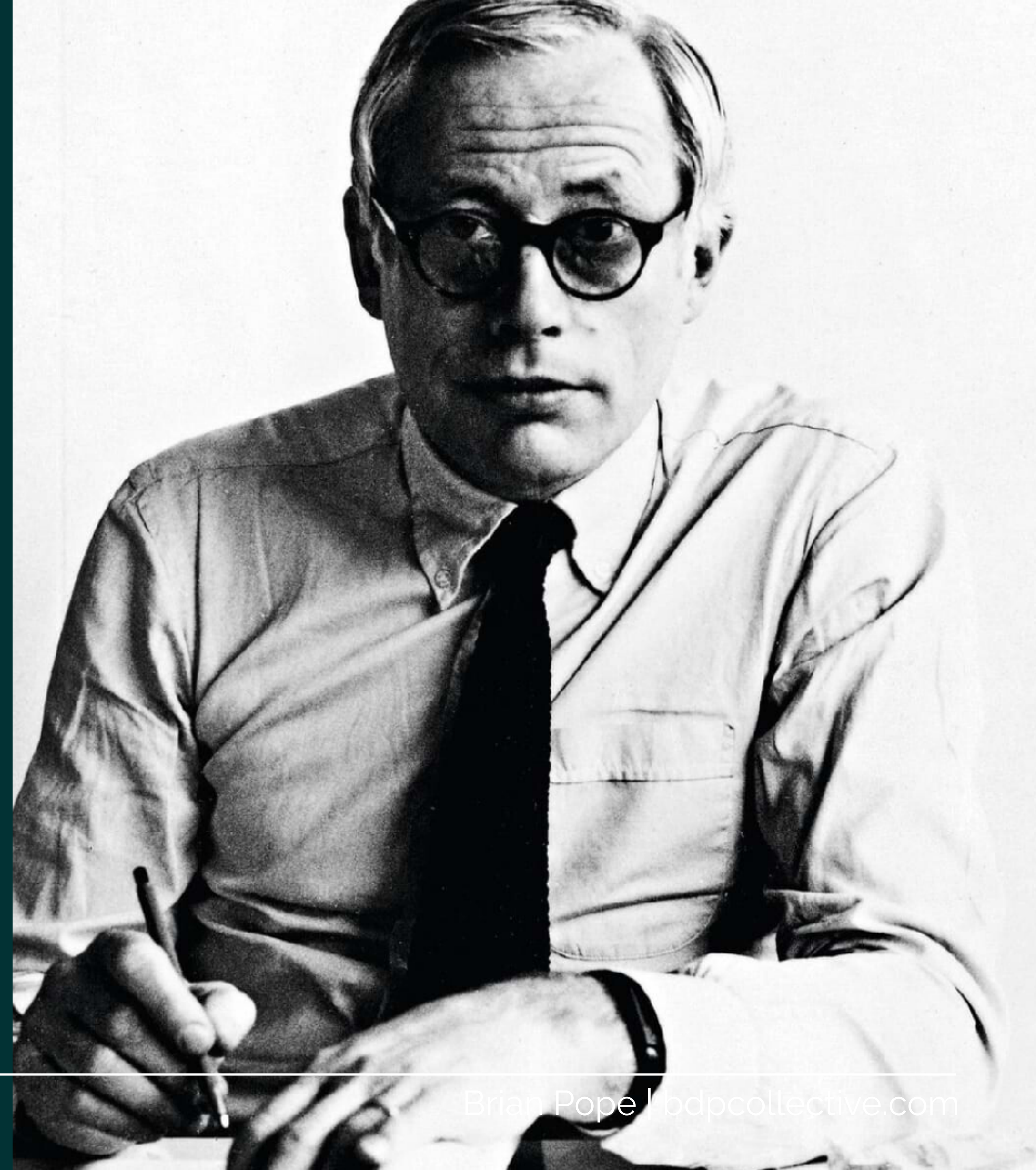
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Teaching AI Good Taste

Techniques

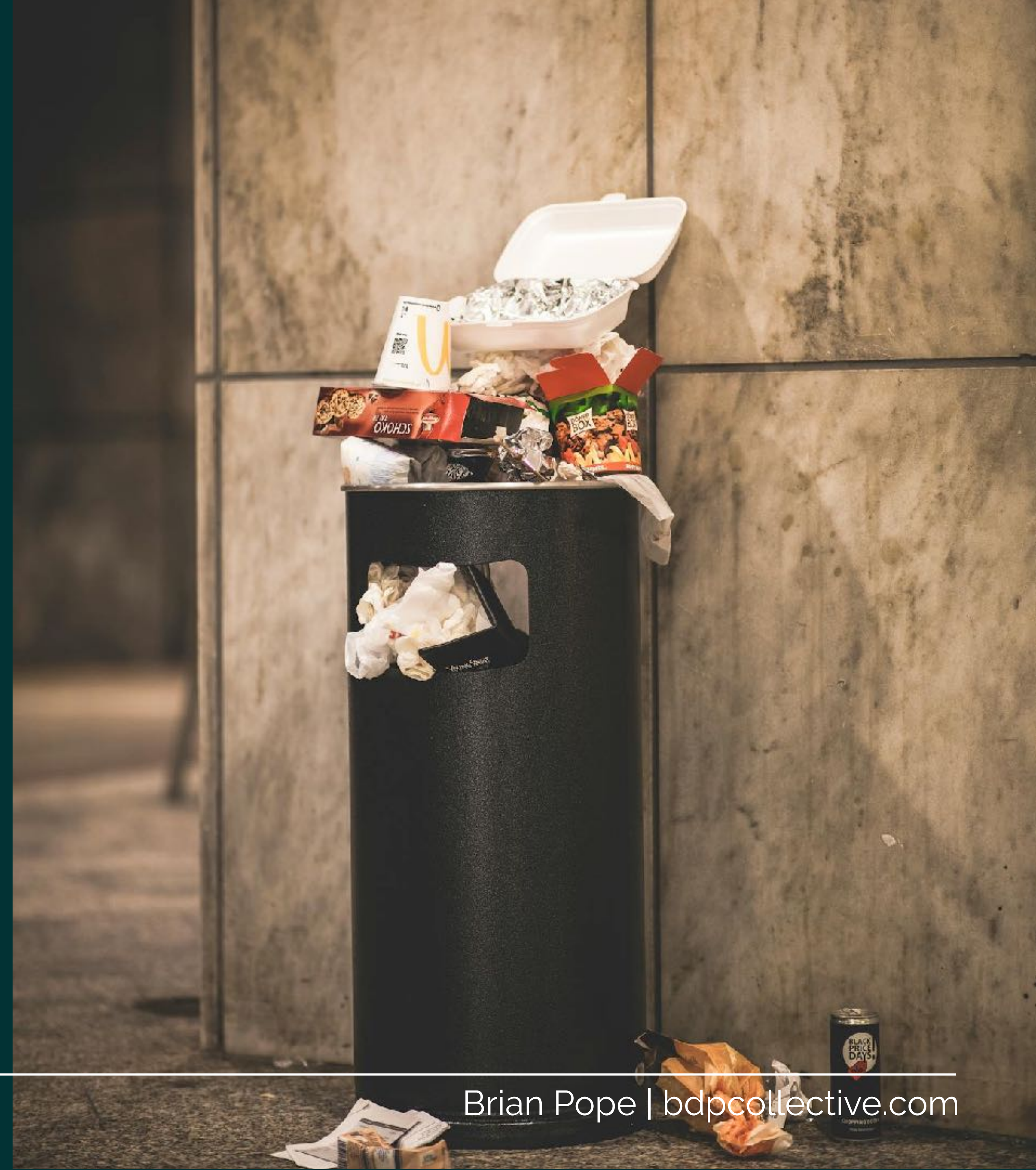
- Use design references (Edward Tufte, Apple, Stripe, Dieter Rams, etc.)
- Broaden inspiration sources (Music videos, Art, Culture)
- Build prompt libraries
- Iterate with focused feedback



Addressing Concerns

The Elephant in the Room

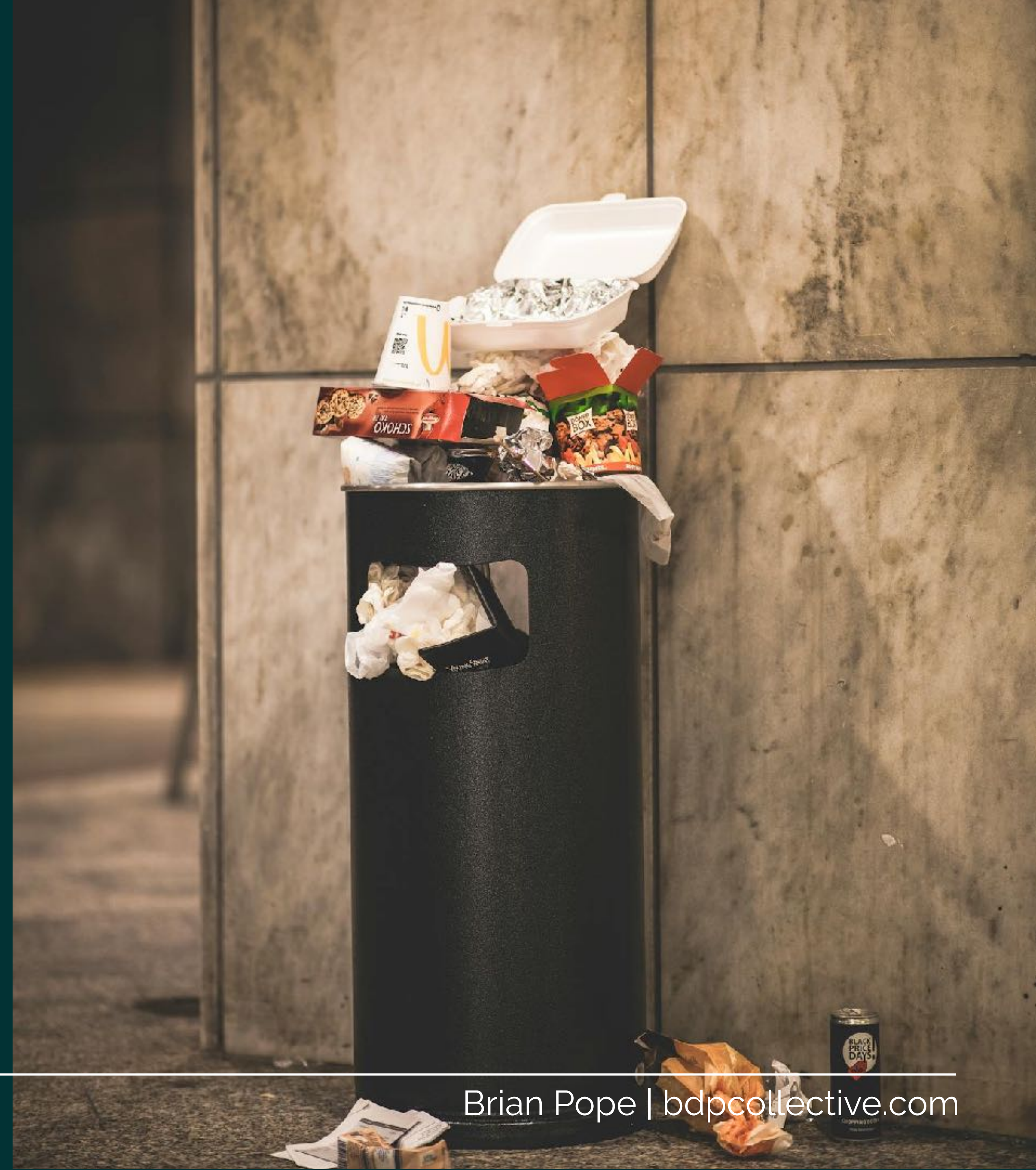
- Bias in AI systems



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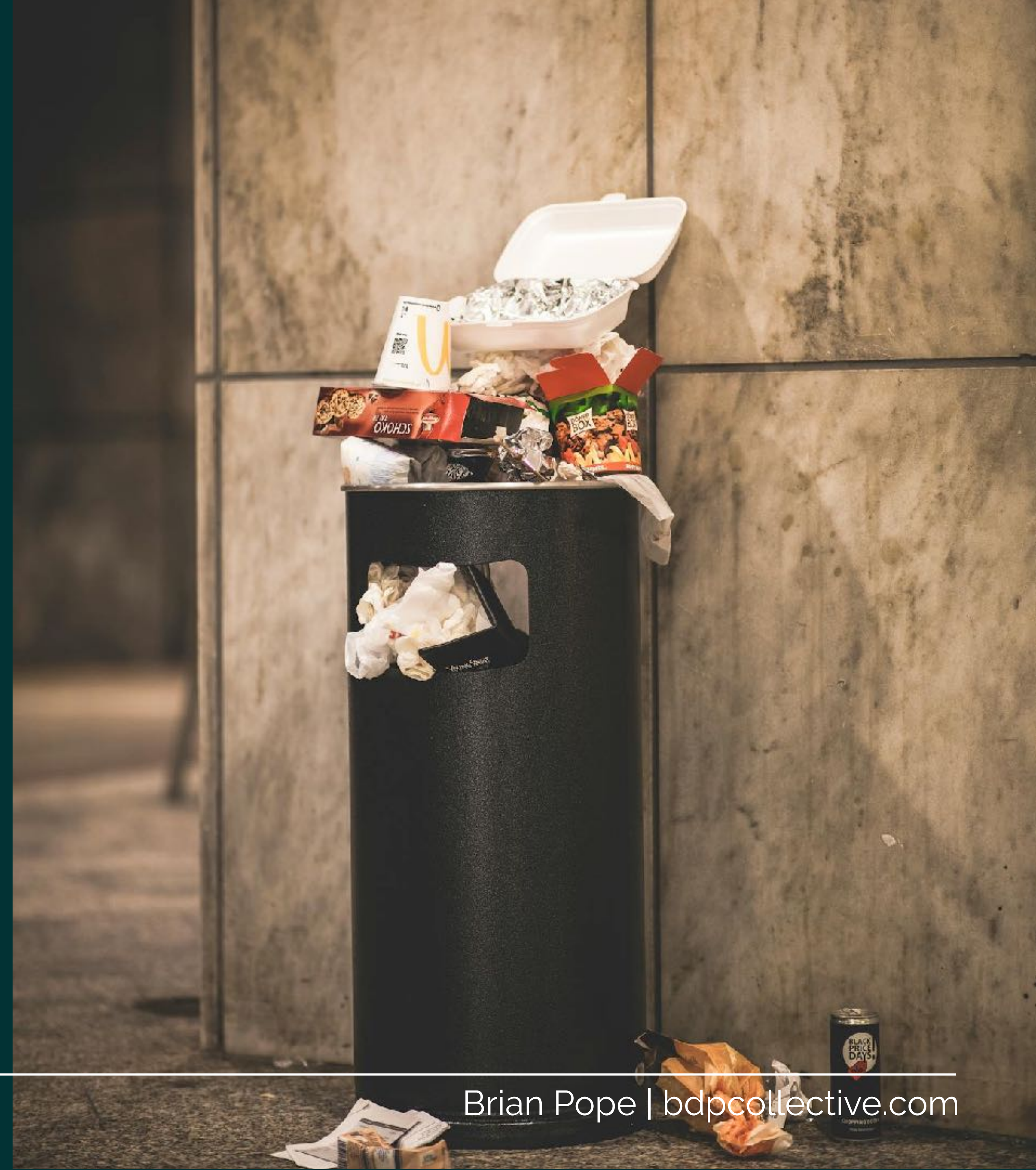
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- Security and data privacy



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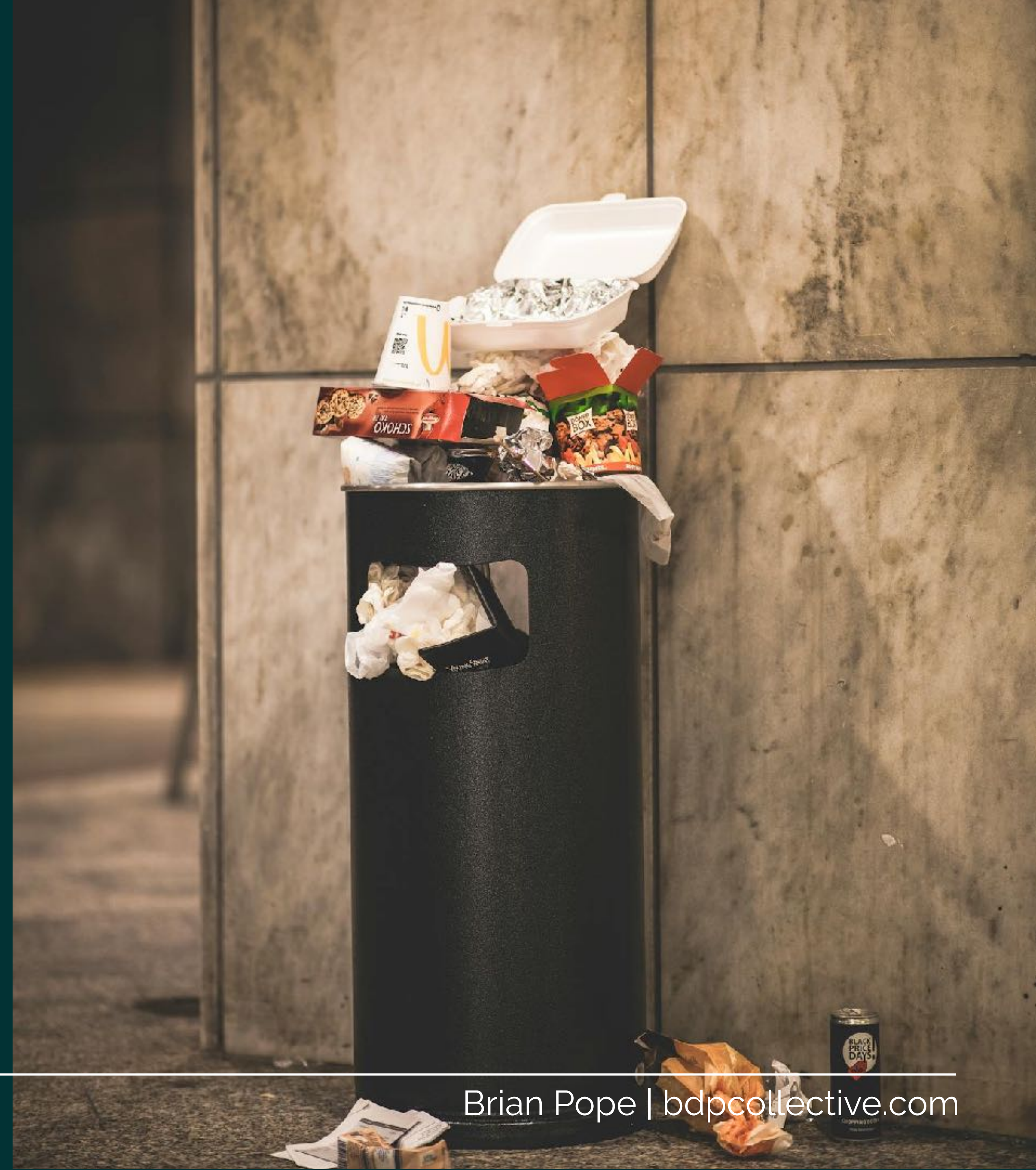
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- Copyright and trademark issues



Addressing Concerns

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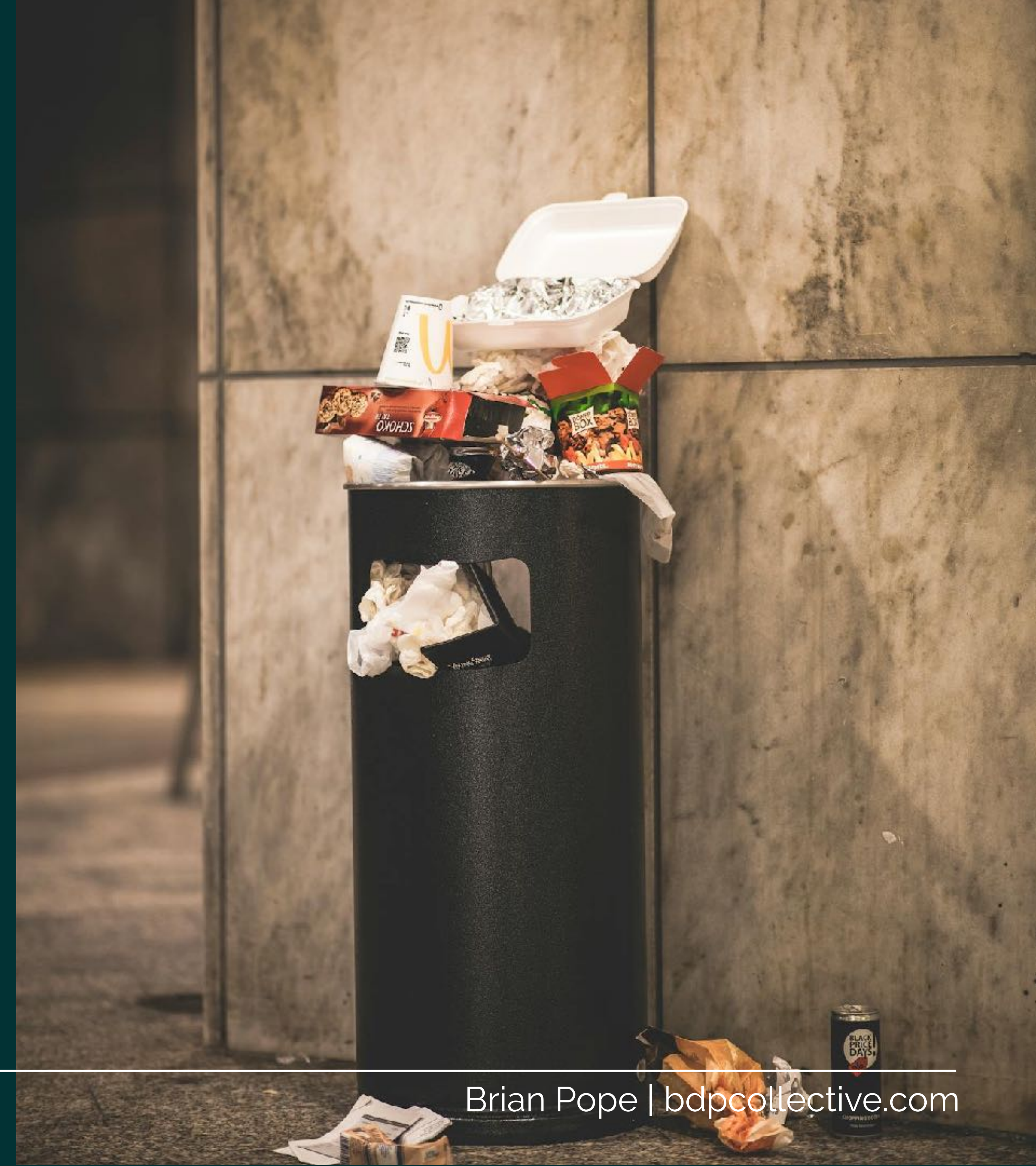
- Bias in AI systems
- Security and data privacy
- Copyright and trademark issues
- Spacing and overlapping issues



Addressing Concerns

The Elephant in the Room

- Bias in AI systems
- Security and data privacy
- Copyright and trademark issues
- Spacing and overlapping issues
- Inconsistent after any changes

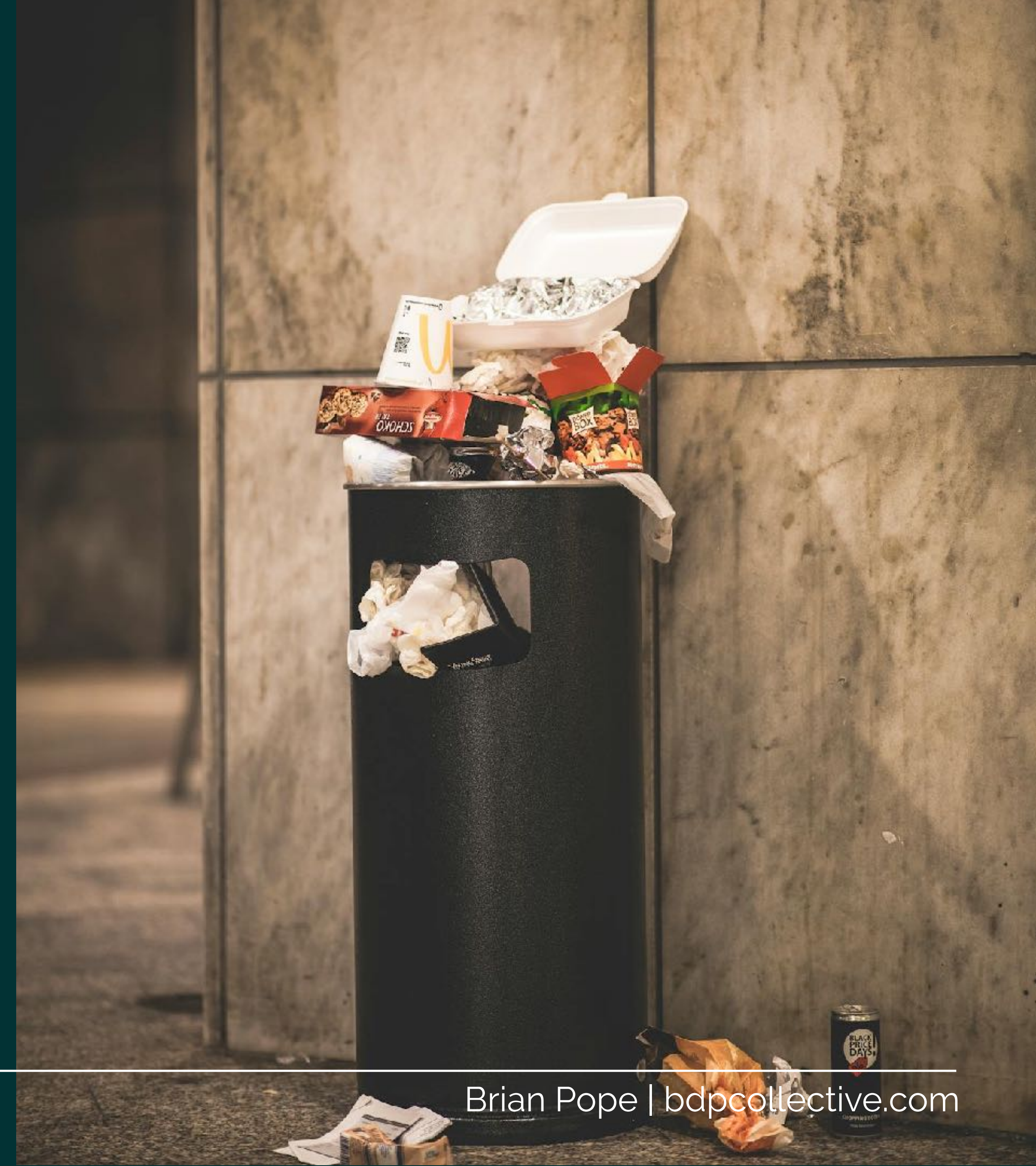


Addressing Concerns

The Elephant in the Room

- Bias in AI systems
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- Copyright and trademark issues
- Spacing and overlapping issues
- Inconsistent after any changes

Use AI thoughtfully, not blindly



Transformation

Value

- Faster iterations and updates



Transformation

Value

- Faster iterations and updates
- Attachment to work and ideas. Prototypes are disposable.



Transformation

Value

- Faster iterations and updates
- Attachment to work and ideas. Prototypes are disposable.
- Real-time collaborative prototyping



Transformation

Value

- Faster iterations and updates
- Attachment to work and ideas. Prototypes are disposable.
- Real-time collaborative prototyping
- Research is converted to design, fundamentally different team conversations



Call to Action

Key Takeaways

- Automate tasks you don't like to do



Key Takeaways

- Automate tasks you don't like to do
- Increase productivity through real-time collaboration



Key Takeaways

- Automate tasks you don't like to do
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- Build clickable prototypes with real functionality



Key Takeaways

- Automate tasks you don't like to do
- Increase productivity through real-time collaboration
- Build clickable prototypes with real functionality
- Preparing context helps the AI make realistic choices



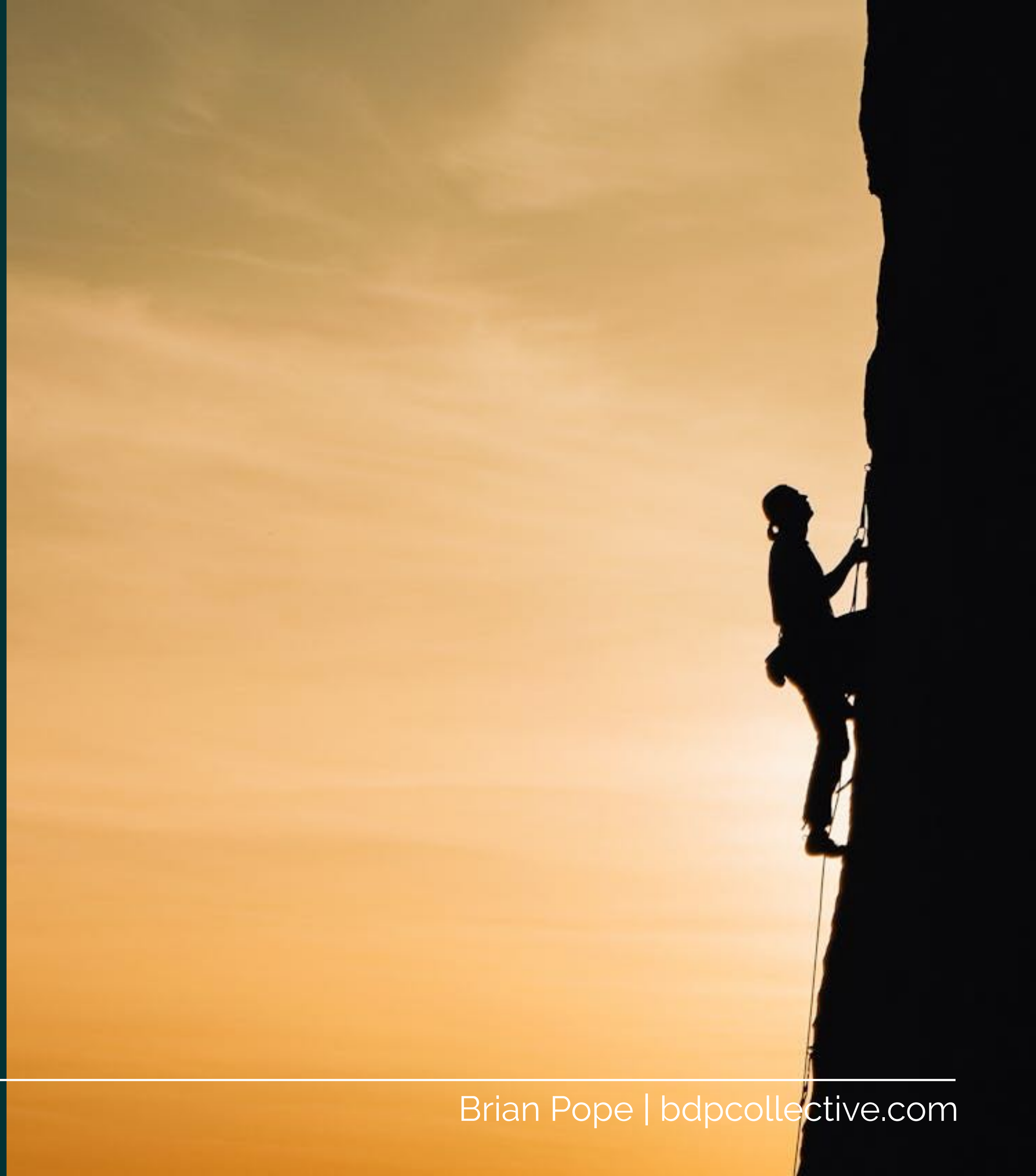
Key Takeaways

- Automate tasks you don't like to do
- Increase productivity through real-time collaboration
- Build clickable prototypes with real functionality
- Preparing context helps the AI make realistic choices
- Save project rules and guidelines for to feed LLM for consistency



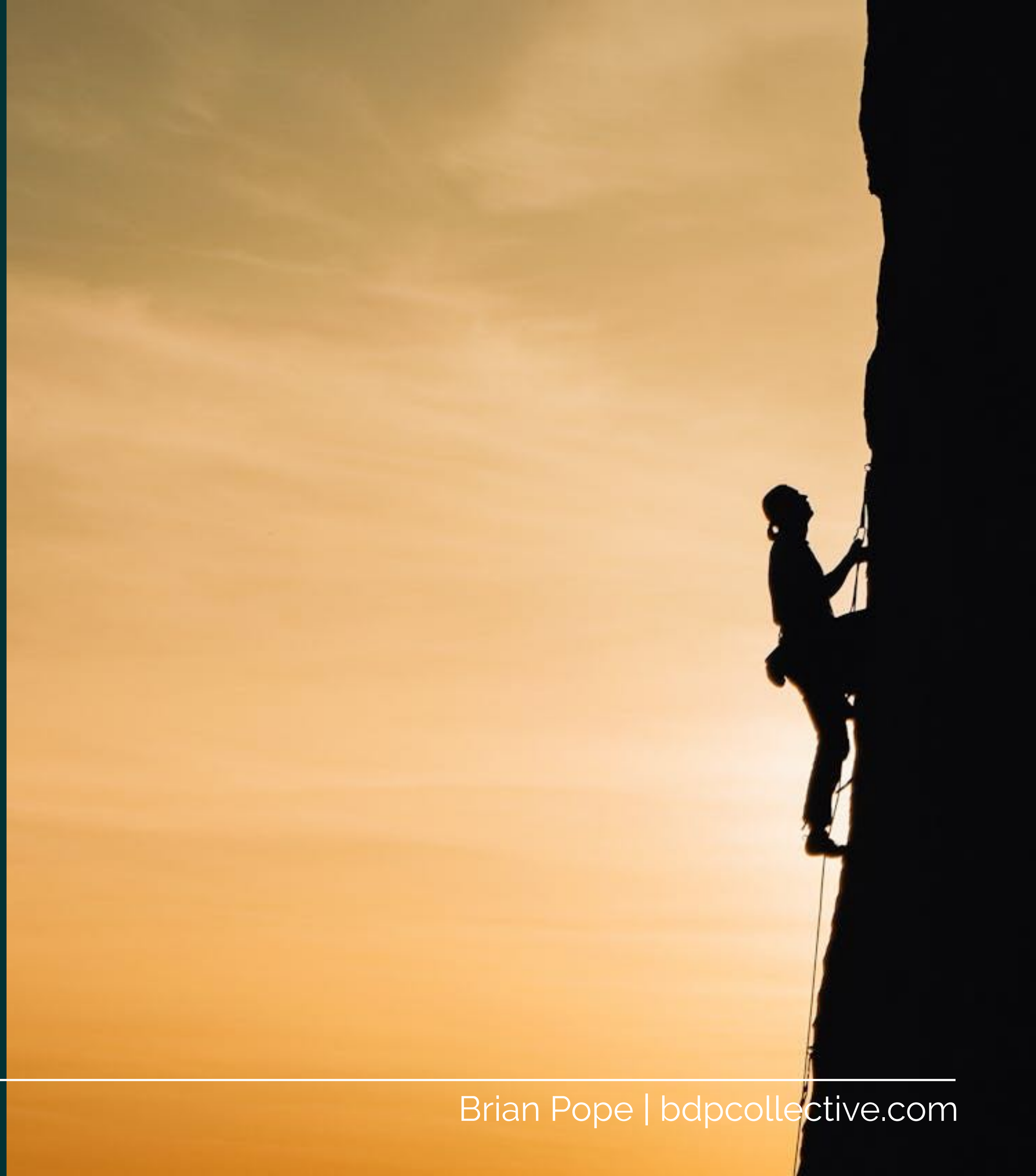
Challenges

- Being open to try new processes



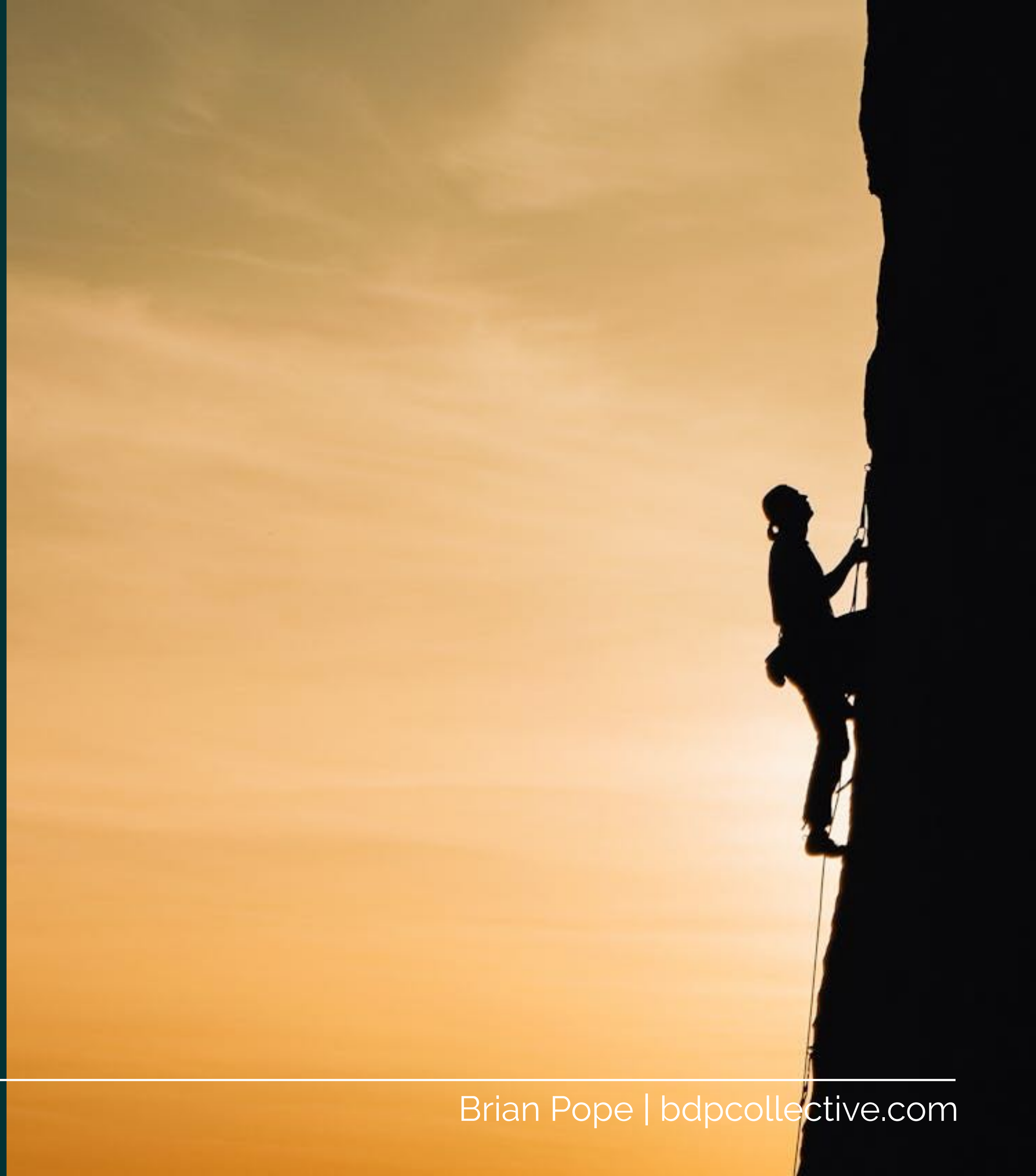
Challenges

- Being open to try new processes
- Keeping up with technology



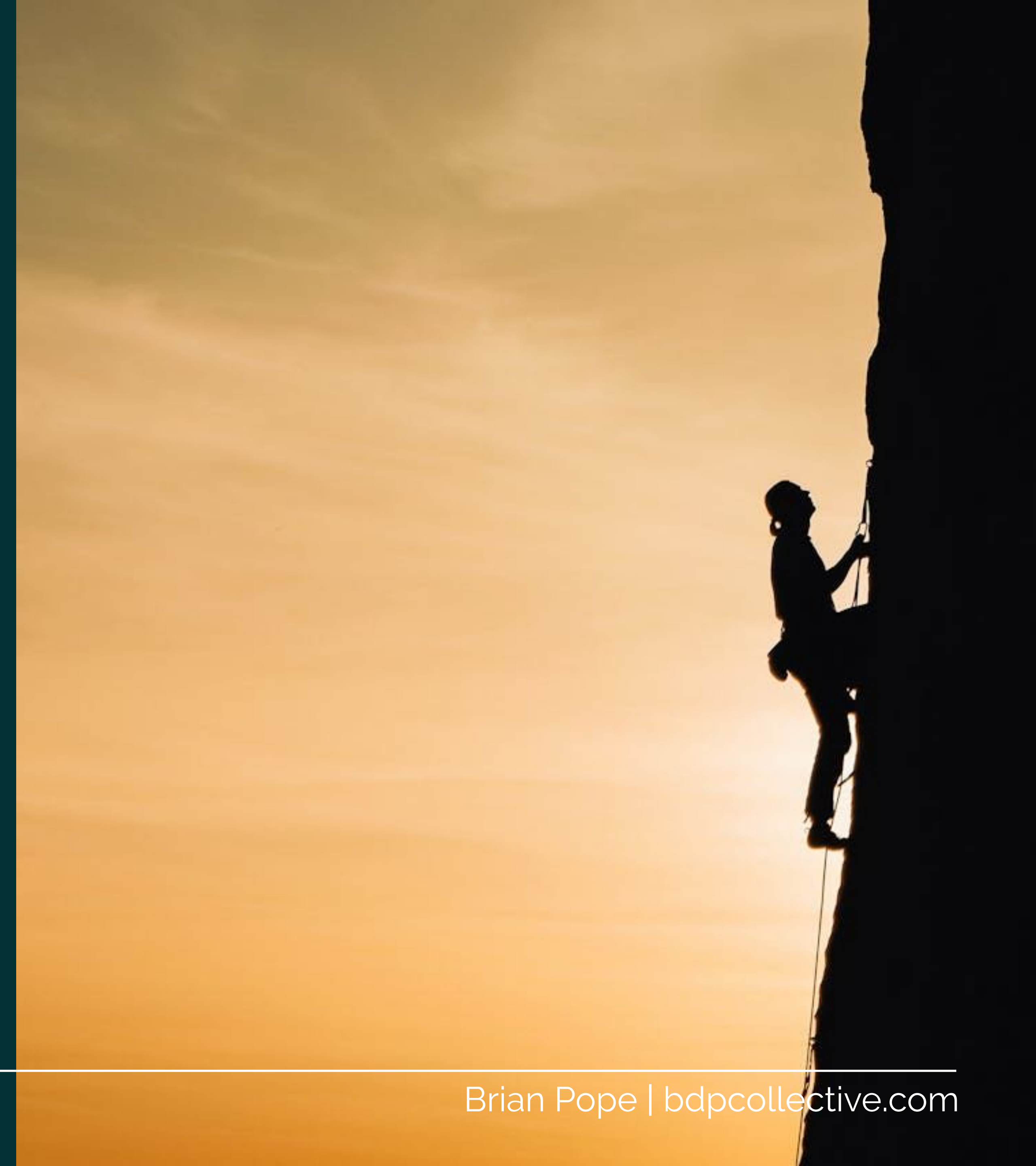
Challenges

- Being open to try new processes
- Keeping up with technology
- Taking the time to learn



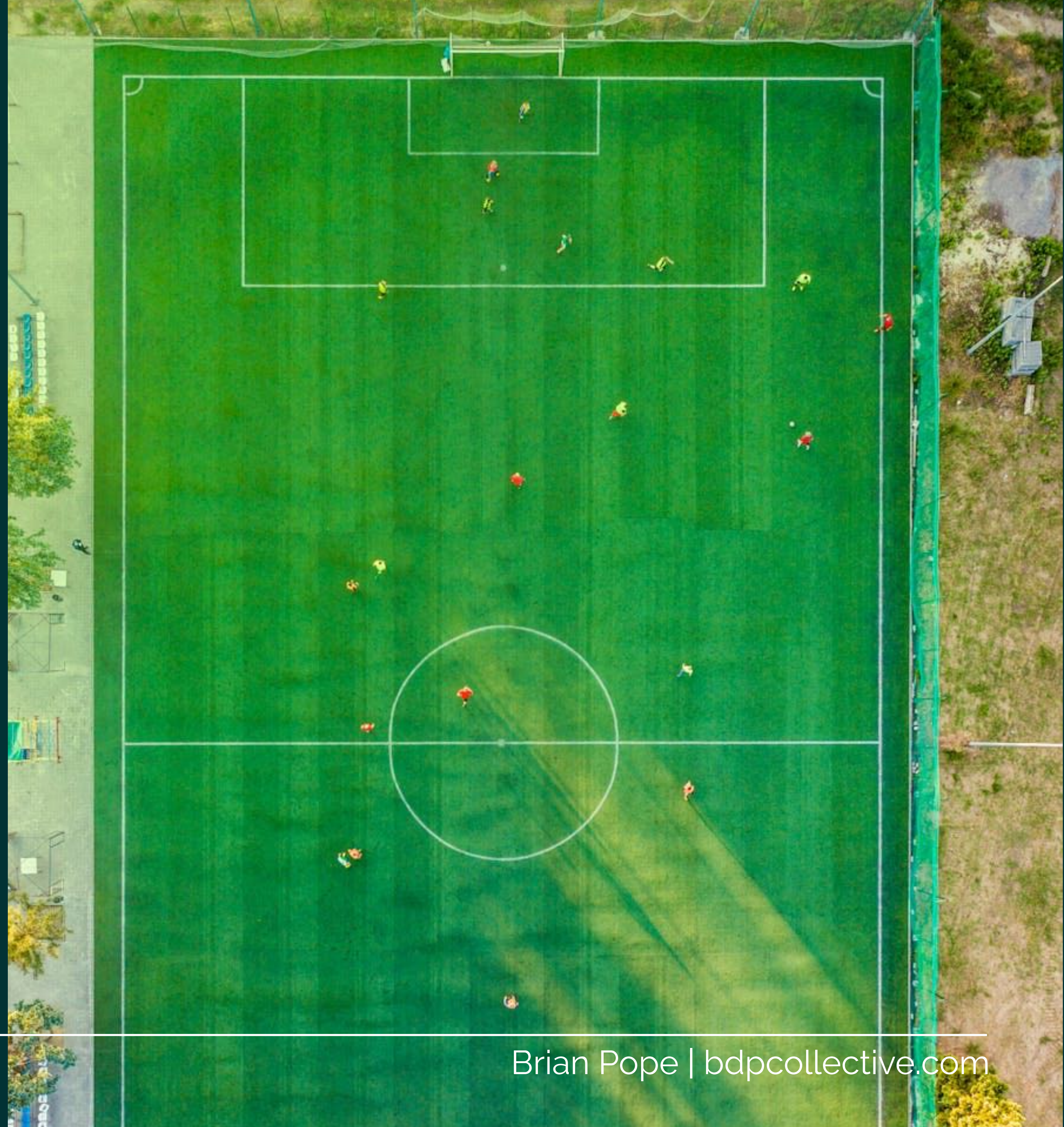
Challenges

- Being open to try new processes
- Keeping up with technology
- Taking the time to learn
- Don't look for flaws, look for solutions



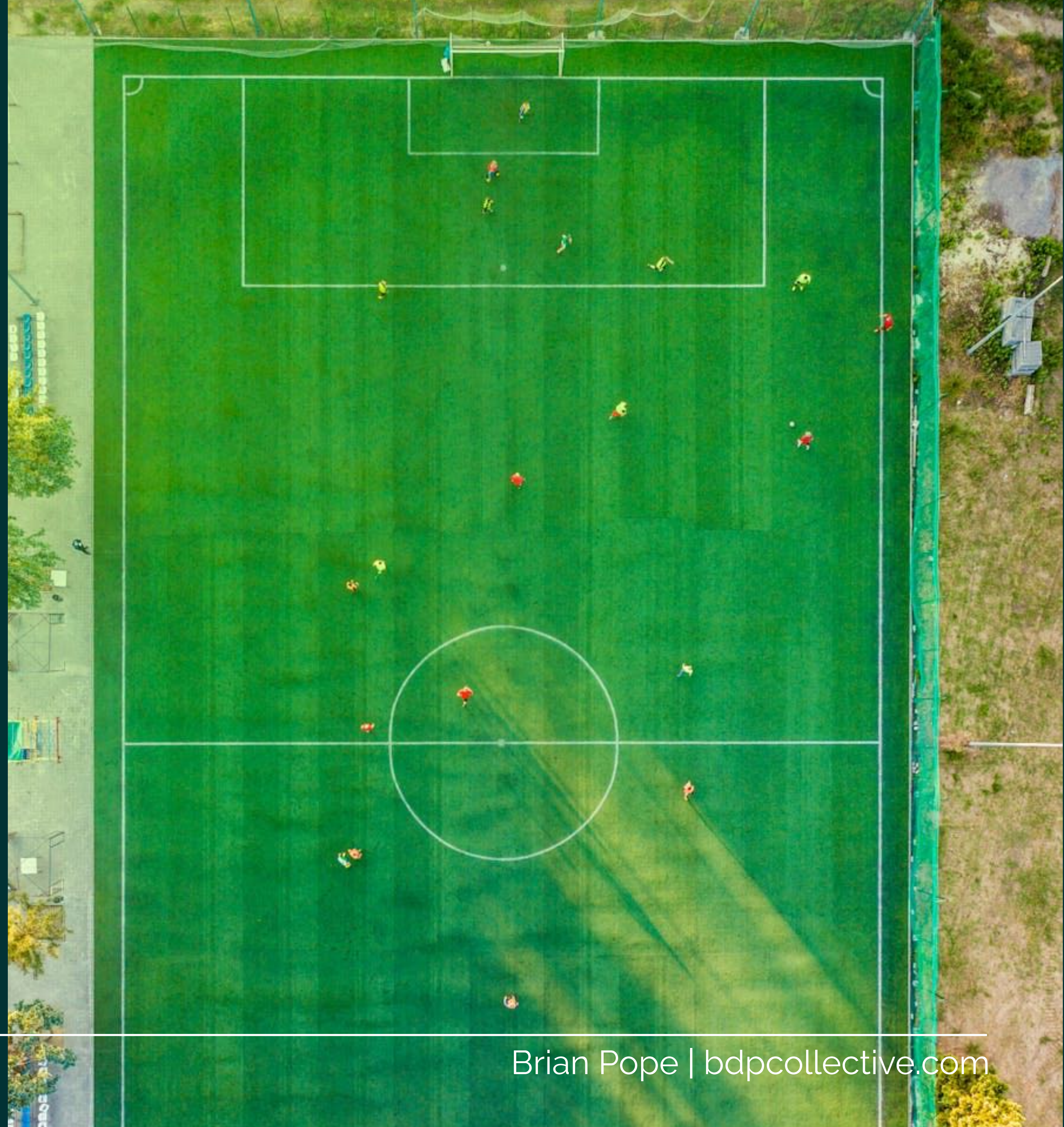
Your Challenge

- Start with one design next week



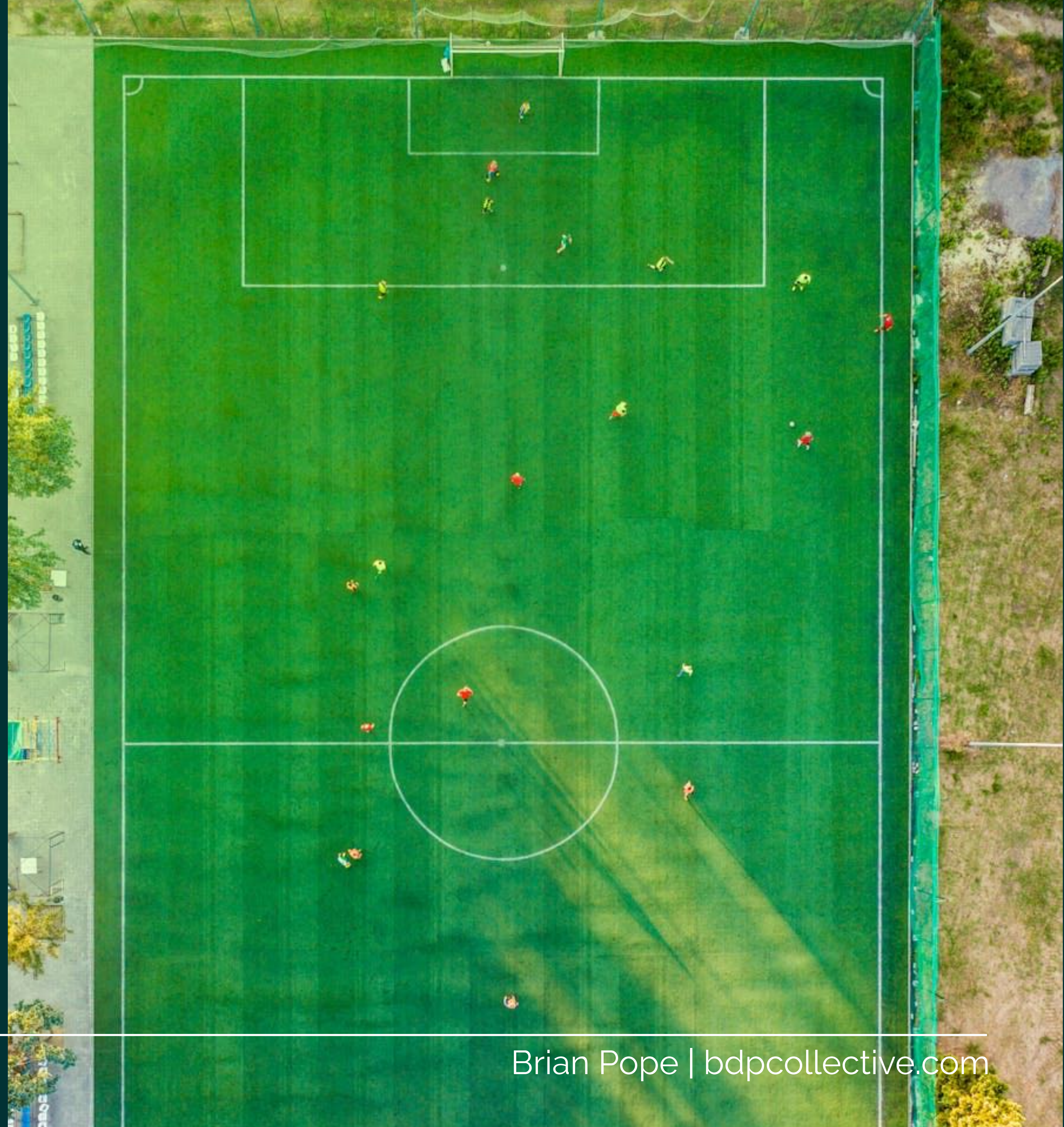
Your Challenge

- Start with one design next week
- Give AI the right context



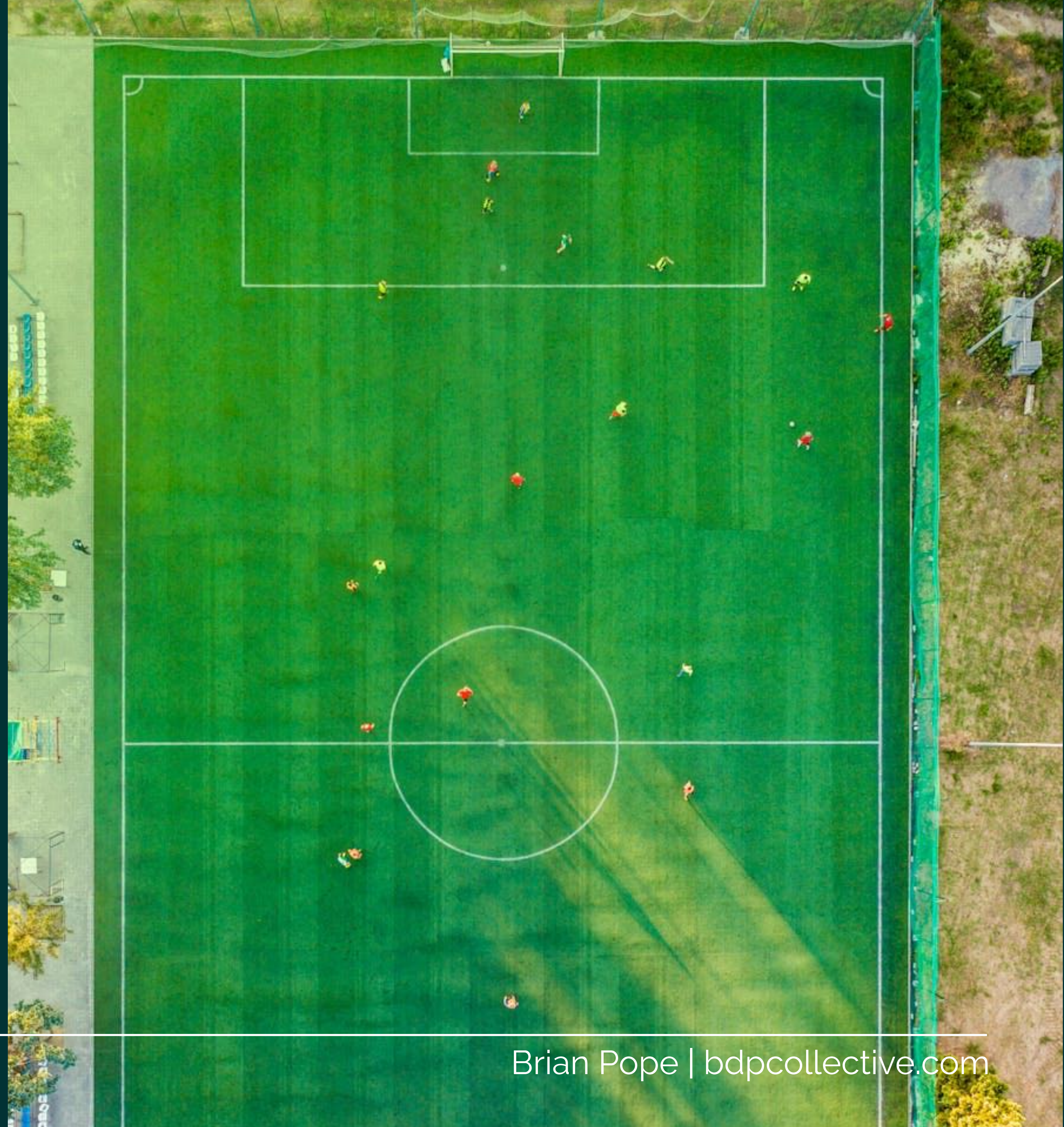
Your Challenge

- Start with one design next week
- Give AI the right context
- Embrace the unexpected



Your Challenge

- Start with one design next week
- Give AI the right context
- Embrace the unexpected
- Iterate with your team



Sources

Cursor

cursor.sh

Windsurf

<https://windsurf.com/>

Claude

claude.ai

Claude Code

<https://www.anthropic.com/claude-code>

Lenny's Podcast

<https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/podcast>

Nate B. Jones

<https://www.youtube.com/@NateBJones/>

AI LABS

<https://www.youtube.com/@AILABS-393>

Questions & Discussion

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brian.pope@devobsessed.com

LinkedIn

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/popeb/>